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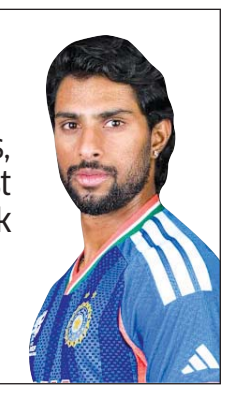
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Shah to Rahul: Brace for 2029 rout

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi



Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday launched a sharp attack on Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, accusing the Opposition of staging protests against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and warning that the party should brace for another crushing defeat in the 2029 Lok Sabha elections.

Addressing reporters, Shah asserted that the people of the country stand firmly with the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), the National Democratic Alliance (NDA), and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, and that the Congress cannot reverse this reality through what he described as negative politics.

Shah said the Congress must abandon its current approach and genuinely try to understand public sentiment and connect with voters. "I want to tell Shri Rahul ji and his associates to prepare themselves once again for a crushing defeat in 2029. In the 2029 general elections, the NDA will win with a resounding majority, and the Congress will face defeat for the fourth consecutive time. The people of this country are with Narendra Modi ji, with the BJP, with the NDA. You cannot deny this truth," he said.

Turning to the Opposition's ongoing protests against the CEC, Shah questioned Gandhi's motives and alleged that the Congress leader was seeking to get "infiltrators" registered as voters. He directly challenged the claim that recent electoral outcomes were linked to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. "I want to ask Shri Rahul Gandhi ji directly: Is this the result of the SIR? The SIR started only after 2024," Shah said.

He noted that the Congress has suffered continuous electoral setbacks since Gandhi became its principal leader, later its president, and now Leader of the Opposition. "You need to engage in introspection. You cannot win the trust of the country's people through fabricated media events and echoes of lies," Shah added.

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SIR ROW: SUPREME COURT DEFERS HEARING TO OCTOBER 15

New Delhi: As the INDIA Bloc leaders led by Rahul Gandhi were busy formulating a joint strategy for continuing protests over alleged vote theft and electoral roll irregularities, the Supreme Court on Tuesday deferred to October 15 the hearing on pleas related to protests against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in Delhi and the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The hearing was postponed after Justice V Mohana fell ill, with the parties agreeing to the adjournment. The matters were listed before a bench headed by CJI Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The top court also sought the presence of a senior Delhi Police officer to respond to allegations by women journalists that they were assaulted while covering the protests.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

RAHUL VOWS TO CONTINUE FIGHT FOR DEMOCRACY

New Delhi: The Opposition INDIA bloc and civil society on Tuesday vowed to unitedly fight what they called the "restoration of the democratic process in the country", with Rahul Gandhi asserting that the political and people's resistance would continue and will triumph.

Addressing media after deliberations with INDIA bloc and civil society members at his residence, the Leader of the Opposition (LoP) in the Lok Sabha said this is the opposition's commitment that the people who have indulged in "vote chori" would be brought to justice, naming Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Rahul hosted Opposition leaders from the grouping, along with civil society members and student leaders, for tea at his residence.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



IMF raises India's FY27 growth forecast to 7%

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Despite global headwinds, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) has raised India's GDP growth forecast to 7 per cent for 2026-27, up from 6.4 per cent in July. It also rated India among the fastest-growing major economies despite growing uncertainties.

The revision in the estimate comes on the back of a "stronger-than-expected momentum, supported by resilient domestic demand and robust services activity". This comes just a week after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) hiked its GDP growth estimate to 7.1 per cent for this year.

"India stands out with upward revisions, reflecting sustained momentum and growing evidence of stronger growth potential supported by favourable demographic dynamics, a large and expanding domestic market, and continued structural reforms," the IMF said in an update to its flagship World Economic Outlook report.

In 2026, the IMF sees the world growing by 3.1 per cent, only slightly higher than 3% in July. Meanwhile, global growth in 2027 is seen unchanged at 3.4%.

Favourable demographics, a large and expanding domestic market, and continued structural reforms supported India's growth prospects, even as higher oil prices posed a challenge.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Several feared drowned as boat capsizes in Bihar district

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Hajipur

Several people were feared drowned after a boat capsized in the Ganga River in Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday evening, officials said.

Sources said most of those on the ill-fated boat were children. The incident occurred under the Raghopur police station's jurisdiction in Vaishali district, as people were on their way to attend a feast in a village across the river, officials said.



Meanwhile, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced an ex gratia of ₹2 lakh to the next of kin of each deceased and ₹50,000 to each injured.

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary condoled the loss of life in the incident and announced an ex gratia of ₹4 lakh to the kin of each deceased.

The Bystander



Murugan resigns, leaves RS also



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

In a surprising move, Union Minister of State L Murugan resigned from the Modi Government on Tuesday, saying he wanted to return to Tamil Nadu to strengthen the BJP in the state, sparking speculation about an imminent reshuffle of the Council of Ministers.

This was the third resignation of a Minister of State (MoS) from the Council of Ministers after George Kurian and Ravneet Singh Bittu, who quit in June and July, respectively, after they were not renominated for Rajya Sabha elections by the BJP.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

India is the Mother of Democracy: PM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Tuesday that India is the "mother of democracy," and open debates, different perspectives, a robust free media landscape, and linguistic diversity are part of its ethos, in an apparent riposte to the ongoing Opposition protests.

Making these assertions here, he said the concept of 'Power to Empower' is deeply ingrained in its culture and traditions and actively applied to the nation's governance and work culture. The true value of knowledge, wealth, and power is determined entirely by how ethically they are utilised, Modi added.

> "MOVING BEYOND THE POWER TO SUCCEED TO THE POWER TO HELP OTHERS SUCCEED, THE VISION WITH WHICH I HAVE COME HERE TODAY IS POWER TO EMPOWER

The Prime Minister also said India's economic growth was anchored in strong fundamentals and sustained reform, noting that the country sought to expand its global economic influence through shared prosperity rather than at the expense of other nations.

Underlining these values while addressing the Bloomberg New Economic Forum, the Prime Minister showcased the vibrant dynamism of the 'Mother of Democracy,' listing the nation's massive linguistic diversity, its 80,000 publications, and over a thousand television channels.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

2 Maldivian pilots held in Flydubai probe

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



Two Maldivian pilots employed by Flydubai have reportedly been detained by authorities in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) as part of an investigation into an alleged attempt to hijack a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight involving an Omani co-pilot.

According to Maldivian media, the two pilots were taken into custody on October 3. The Maldivian Embassy in the UAE subsequently informed their families of the detentions. Authorities have not publicly disclosed the specific allegations against the men or clarified whether they were directly involved in the incident.

The investigation follows an alleged attack aboard Flydubai Flight FZ1073 on September 30, when Omani national Hammam al-Hammami, 29, reportedly attacked Indian Captain Smit Machchhar in an attempt to take control of the aircraft and crash it.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

When protests empty the streets, businesses pay the price

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi



From the farmers' agitation at Delhi's borders to the anti-CAA sit-in at Shaheen Bagh, protests have repeatedly disrupted the movement of people and goods, leaving traders to calculate the cost of political mobilisation. During the farmers' agitation in 2020-21, traders' bodies estimated losses running into thousands of crores as border blockades slowed supplies to Delhi's markets.

During the anti-CAA protests, businesses around Shaheen Bagh reported falling sales and prolonged disruption, with the road blockade affecting some 300 retail shops, showrooms, offices and restaurants. Now, as protests over the revision of electoral rolls bring barricades and security restrictions back to central Delhi, traders in Connaught Place face a familiar problem: fewer customers, uncertain access, and earnings that cannot be recovered once a day is lost.

The impact of the latest disruption became apparent on Tuesday, when Connaught Place's commercial stretches attempted to return to routine after a day of protests and movement restrictions.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



DJB launches door-to-door e-KYC drive to revamp water bills

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Jal Board (DJB) has launched its door-to-door e-KYC drive across the city to revamp its water bill management system, identify genuine customers, reduce water loss and create a digital ID, officials said on Tuesday.

"Our effort is to fix these gaps at the ground level and build a system that is accurate, transparent and trustworthy. This will help consumers get digital bills by email and WhatsApp. Many customers complained about not getting proper, timely bills," an official said.

By tightening its billing systems, the DJB aims to ensure location accuracy and eliminate duplicate or incorrect premises from its records.

"Check the authorised ID of the metre reader; do not pay. DJB field agents are strictly not authorised to collect cash or any other gifts. Never share original documents," the civic body said in the public notice.

The DJB currently has around 30 lakh registered consumers. However, only 40 per cent of them receive proper water bills. The drive will help in reducing illegal connections, which will help in revenue generation.

According to the officials, an authorised field agent will visit each house and take pictures of the metre and update the GPS coordinates, after which the digital record will be updated on the Revenue Management System (RMS) of the DJB and will be verified with a one-time password (OTP) on the registered mobile number.

Water Minister Parvesh Verma had earlier said that water billing has become a major source of distress for households. The board has approved a digital database update drive covering nearly 35 lakh consumers. The project was approved in April this year by the Delhi Government.

"The existing scale of operations, legacy processes, manual interventions and fragmented field operations have resulted in challenges related to billing accuracy, consumer data quality, service transparency and revenue efficiency," an official said.

Currently, the DJB reports nearly 50 per cent non-revenue water (NRW). This means more than half of the water supplied does not generate revenue, either due to leakages, theft, or unbilled usage. Officials believe that formalising water usage through the registration process could significantly help in reducing these losses.

Govt boosts anti-pollution grid with 13 AQI stations, 150 electic buses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday reviewed pollution control measures at the Delhi Pollution Control Committee's Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC).

They also virtually inaugurated 13 air quality monitoring stations, 150 electric buses and four high-capacity charging stations in the national Capital.

During the review, Yadav highlighted the Delhi Government's 11 action points to tackle air pollution, saying coordinated action by multiple agencies had helped improve air quality at Anand Vihar, a major pollution hotspot in the city.

With the launch of new Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Stations (CAAQMS), the network has now been expanded to 60 stations from 47, providing real-time air quality data through the CPCB server as well as the SAMEER mobile app. These stations will continuously track major pollutants, including PM2.5 and PM10.

"Air Quality Index (AQI) at Anand Vihar had dropped from 430 on August 30 to 92, attributing the improvement to coordinated efforts by the Government, the traffic police, the public works department and other agencies. Anand Vihar had become a major air pollution hotspot due to traffic congestion, traffic of commuting buses at the bus terminal, road dust along roadsides, etc," Yadav said.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that tackling Delhi's pollution challenge requires a rapid shift towards electric public transport and stronger supporting infrastructure.

"The addition of 150 electric buses and the launch of public EV charging stations at five locations marked significant progress in this direction. The Government aims to provide better transport facilities to Delhi residents and accelerate efforts to make the Capital cleaner and more sustainable," Gupta said in a statement.

Union Minister Yadav said the Delhi Government had increased the fleet of electric and CNG buses to more than 6,000 and established charging infrastructure to support their operations.

CM Rekha attacks Congress over assault on woman journalist during protest

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said that the "anti-women" face of Congress and its leader Rahul Gandhi was exposed after the "assault and indecency" faced by a pregnant female journalist at the party's protest.

She also slammed Gandhi's sister, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, for her "silence" over the "sexual harassment" charge faced by a Congress MP.

In a post on X, Gupta claimed that a "three-month pregnant woman journalist Richa Parashar" was assaulted while covering the Congress protest on Monday in the national Capital. "The violence against a pregnant woman journalist simply doing her duty deserves as much condemnation as possible - it's never enough," Gupta said.

"Richa's ordeal exposes the gap between what Congress preaches and what it does," the chief minister said in the post.



She also criticised the party over sexual harassment charges against its Inner Manipur MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam, who was recently dismissed as a JNU professor in the wake of the allegations.

"Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi have kept mum over the Congress MP accused of sexual harassment of 11 JNU daughters. The real character of political parties issuing '*Ladki Hun Lad Sakti Hun*' type poll slogans is before the people," Gupta said.

She said that on Monday, when BJP Mahila Morcha activists protested outside Congress headquarters, they met with "indecent behaviour and vulgar abuses."

A BJP delegation, earlier in the day, filed a police complaint, seeking action against Congress workers over the incident.

"The country is watching Rahul Gandhi and Congress's so-called respect for women. The public will respond and hold them accountable," Gupta asserted.

The Pioneer
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CHANGE OF NAME

I, Ashwani S/o Jagpal R/o Gali No. 3, Prem Colony, Bawana Road, Narela, North West Delhi, Delhi-110040 declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Jagpal Singh in my 10th and 12th class educational documents. The actual name of my father is Jagpal, which may be amended accordingly.

I, Tulshi Ram, Father of No. 15572379A Hav Sharwan Kumar Kumawat, R/o- VPO- Kuharwas, Teh- Buhana, Dist- Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan- 333034, have changed my name from Tulshi Ram to Tulsi Ram, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Banarshi Devi, Mother of No. 15572379A Hav Sharwan Kumar Kumawat, R/o- VPO- Kuharwas, Teh- Buhana, Dist- Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan- 333034, have changed my name from Banarshi Devi to Banarsi Devi, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Natrajan K, Father of- JC-292244P SUB (DS) N Ramalingam, R/o- Vill & PO- Kothakottai, Teh- Vaniyambadi, Dist- Vellore, Tamil Nadu- 635752, have changed my name from Natrajan K to Natarajan K, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Deonandan Yadav, Father of No.15688615P Hav Birendra Prasad, R/o- Vill- Dhobiyahi, Post- Garha, PS- Ladania, Teh- Jaynagar, Dist- Madhubani, Bihar- 847232, have changed my name from Deonandan Yadav to Devnandan Yadav, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, R Saroja, Mother of- JC-292244P SUB (DS) N Ramalingam, R/o- Vill & PO- Kothakottai, Teh- Vaniyambadi, Dist- Vellore, Tamil Nadu- 635752, have changed my name from R Saroja to Saroja, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, P Devagi, W/o- JC-292244P SUB (DS) N Ramalingam, R/o- Vill & PO- Kothakottai, Teh- Vaniyambadi, Dist- Vellore, Tamil Nadu- 635752, have changed my name from P Devagi to Devagi R, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, JC-473341F Sub Satendra Singh Bhadoriya, R/o- Near Mohite Garden, Chandra Nagar, Gwalior, M.P - 474003, have changed my daughter's name from Ananya to Ananya Bhadoriya, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Mem Wati Devi, Mother of No.16019119F Hav Pardeep Kumar, R/o- Vill- Chhalaundi (67), PO- Ban, Dist- Kurukshetra, Haryana- 136132, have changed my name from Mem Wati Devi to Mem Bati, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Versha, D/o JC-472705W Sub Arun Kumar, R/o- Vill- Chirhara, PO- Suthana, Teh- Bawal, Dist- Rewari, Haryana - 123501, have changed my name from Versha to Varsha, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Chanchal Kumari W/o No.16030817K Rfn Lokesh Kumar, R/o- Vill &PO- Averani, Teh- Mahavan, Dist- Mathura, U.P - 281301, have changed my name from Chanchal Kumari to Chanchal, vide affidavit dated 13/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Ishwar Singh, Father of No. 14661790K Hav Zile Singh, R/o- Vill- Jat Shahpur, PO- Inchhapuri, Teh- Pataudi, Dist- Gurgaon, Haryana - 122414, have changed my name from Iswer Singh to Ishwar Singh, vide affidavit dated 09/10/2026 before Notary Public Gurugram, Haryana.

I, Gayarsi Devi, Mother of No. 14661790K Hav Zile Singh, R/o- Vill- Jat Shahpur, PO- Inchhapuri, Teh- Pataudi, Dist- Gurgaon, Haryana - 122414, have changed my name from Garshi Devi to Gayarsi Devi, vide affidavit dated 09/10/2026 before Notary Public Gurugram, Haryana.

I, Sunil Gusain S/o Manohar Singh Gusain Resident of Flat No-100-D Pocket-A Mayur Vihar Phase -2 Delhi-110091, have changed the name of my minor daughter Aanay Gusain aged 15 years, and he shall hereafter be known as Aanya Gusain.

I, Shalini Singh W/o Manoj Kumar Arya R/o Flat No. 201, Plot No. B-611, Vasant Kunj Enclave, B-Block, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070 have changed my minor Daughter's name from Divyanshi Arya to Sarvani P Arya for all future purposes.

I, Harish Kumar S/o Mohan Lal R/o A-67, West Patel Nagar, New Delhi-110008 have changed my name to Harish Khattar.

I, Komal Jindal D/o Vinay Kumar W/o Vishal Jindal, R/o 8/104, Orange County, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201014, have changed my name from Komal Jindal to Komal Singla for all future purposes.

I, Nikhil Singh, S/O Rakesh Kumar Singh, R/O 335 Site-1, 1st Floor, Vikaspuri, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi- 110018, have changed my name from Nikhil Singh to Ritik Singh for all purposes. Henceforth, Nikhil Singh and Ritik Singh refer to one and the same person.

I, Ram wati Devi W/o Late Sh. Ishwar Singh R/o V.P.O. Deeg Teh. Ballabgarh Distt. Faridabad. Hereby declare that I have changed my name from Ram wati to Ram Rati Devi for all purposes. Henceforth Ram wati and Ram Rati Devi one and the same person.

I, Radha W/o No-14874064X Rank- Hav Name Hem Raj R/o Likhi, PO - Likhi, PS - Hassanpur, Distt - Palwal, Haryana- 121107 have changed my name from Radha to Km Radha. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Km Radha for all future purpose.

I, RUBY W/o Sh. Ramesh Kumar Thakur R/o Flat No. 132, Pocket-E, Mayur Vihar Phase-II, Delhi-110091, has changed my name from Ruby to Ruby Shukla. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Ruby Shukla for all future purpose.

PUBLIC NOTICE

That my Client, Smt. Raksha Sharma, W/o Late Shri Om Prakash Sharma, R/o D- 109, First floor, Narwana Apartment, I.P. extension, Delhi, have disowned and severed all her relations, and association with her elder son Shri Gaurav Sharma, her daughter in law Smt. Priya Sharma, and her Grandson Lakshya Sharma, from 07.10.2026 with immediate effect due to extremely Bad behaviour and physical Injury caused upon my Client and they shall have no right, title, interest, claim or concern whatsoever in any of her movable or immovable properties, assets, investments, bank accounts or other belongings, whether presently owned or acquired by her in future.

Rajesh Kumar Sharma (Advocate), G-303, Lawyers Chamber, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi -110032

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that my client Janak Pokharel S/o PP Pokharel R/o B-539 Fourth Floor right side back portion, Vasant Kunj Enclave, New Delhi-110070 has severed all his professional relations from Sh. Arun Tiwari S/o Bisheswar Dayal Tiwari R/o D-105 Second Floor Shanti Kunj Vasant Kunj New Delhi-110070. My client ceased to be employee of said Arun Tiwari as real estate agent since 2018/2019. My client will not be responsible of any act of Sh. Arun Tiwari after 2018/2019.

Rajkamal(Advocate), Ch. No. 443 Saket Court New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given regarding rebuilding of the property situated at C-484, Chittaranjan Park, New Delhi, PIN-110019. Concerned person/s, if any, are hereby notified to raise a claim/objection with valid legal documents, if any, in support thereof, within 30 days (thirty days) from the date of this paper publication. Thereafter, no such claim shall be entertained and the same shall be deemed to have been waived. Any claim or objection, in writing, should reach Ms. Monalisa Sarkar at K-1995, Chittaranjan Park, New Delhi-110019, or **Mrs. Ivanova Lahiri, at C-484, Chittaranjan Park, New Delhi-110019 both d/o Late Anil Chandra Das.**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Freehold Property No. 141-C, First Floor, Northern side i.e. Right side premises (while facing property from Gali), without terrace rights, measuring about 73.3056 Sq. Yds, situated at Hari Nagar, Ashram, New Delhi-110014 along with One Car Parking and Lift facilities, presently owned by Shri Ranjit Singh by virtue of Sale Deed duly registered vide Regd. No. 2025/9/1/1271, dated 03.03.2025 & as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance.

It is hereby notified that any person and /or Bank, financial institution having any claim, any charge, Beneficiary of Will, HUF / Member of HUF, any interest or lien or claim and /or objection to thereof, he/she/ they may lodge/ notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof / court judgment within 10 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further / future claim/objection(s) shall be rejected & my client/ prospective buyer(s) as a bona-fide purchaser conclude the title/ Sale Deed proposed to be executed in favor of my client or in the name of his/her/ their nominees shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw & impediment.

SATYENDER YADAV (Advocate)
Ch.No.561, 5th Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi. M. 9711212421, Email: satender175@gmail.com

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer are the Possessor of the Plot of land area measuring 770 Sq. yds., Plot No. A-18, area measuring 270 Sq. Yds., out of Khasra No. 249/1min and Plot bearing No. C, area measuring 500 Sq. Yds., out of Khasra No. 249/2min, situated in the revenue Estate of Village Chhattarpur, Tehsil Saket, now known as "Chhattarpur Enclave Phase-II", New Delhi. He is Possession through Regd. GPA, Notarized ATS & Will dated 21.10.2004 executed by Capt. Dilawar Singh Sangwan in favour of Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer in respect of said plots.
Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer intend to transfer the ownership of above said Plots by way of Sale Deed to M/S Lamaison Innovations & Design Private limited though its Director Ms. Jai Laxmi Bai. Subsequently, M/S Lamaison Innovations & Design Private limited though its Director Ms. Jai Laxmi Bai are in the process of mortgaging the said Plots with ICICI Home Finance Co. Limited. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 15 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 15-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.
If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that **Shri Sharat Madan** who is the owner of **House no. 272, area measuring 500 sq. yds., SECTOR-9 URBAN ESTATE FARIDABAD -121002.** Vide Sale Deed Dated 29.03.2004 executed by Smt. Harvinder Jeet Kaur in favour of Shri Sharat Madan in respect of House no. 272, area measuring 500 sq. yds. Regd. Doc. no. 9251 in book no.1 volume no. 0/11 page no. 13-15 SRO-Faridabad, and same to be financed by **ADITYA BIRLA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED That,** Original Regd. Conveyance Deed Dated 22.09.1989 executed by HUDA in favour of Smt. Harvinder Jit Kaur in respect of said property. Regd. Doc. no. 10328 in book no. 1. **has been lost/or not available**, If any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **7 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc.

Lucem Legal LLP
N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049
Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Mr. Akshya Jain S/o. Mr. Adesh Jain and Mr. Pramod Singh C/o. Mr. Jagat Singh has acquired Plot No. 6-A, Land area measuring approx. 67.5 sq.yds., (out of total land measuring 1100 sq. yds.), out of khasra no. 798 min (1-0), 800 (1-0), 801 (2-3), 802 (0-7) and 804 (1-4), situated in the revenue state of Village Asola, Tehsil Saket, New Delhi-110074, vide by way of Notarised SPA, Notarised GPA, Notarised ATS & Notarised Will dated 29.01.2025.
Now, Mr. Akshya Jain S/o. Mr. Adesh Jain and Mr. Pramod Singh C/o. Mr. Jagat Singh intending sell above said property to Mr. Aakash s/o. Mr. Jeet Singh and further availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that **Mrs. Nirmala Devi W/o Mr. Roop Ram** intends to purchase the **Freehold House constructed on Plot No. 4, admeasuring 50 Sq. Yds., forming part of Khasra No. 2316, situated at Village Dadri, Mahadev Puram, Dadri, District Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh**. The aforesaid property is proposed to be purchased from **Mr. Mahender S/o Mr. Jay Chand,** who, along with others, is recorded as a co-owner of land admeasuring **1.364000 Hectares, comprised in Khasra No. 2316,** by virtue of the **Khatauni for Fasli Years 1429-1434**, issued by the concerned Revenue Department. The boundaries of the aforesaid property are as follows:**East**: Other Property, **West**: Road 22 ft. wide, **North**: Other plot of Chander Prakas & **South**: Vacant Plot. The aforesaid property is proposed to be mortgaged by the borrower with **Niwas Housing Finance Limited** as security for the financial facility. Any person having any claim or objection must notify the undersigned in writing within 7 days, failing which it will be presumed there are no objections.

NCR LAW ASSOCIATES Advocates & Consultants A-98, Sector-09, New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh -201009
Mobile: 9999721152 / 9999826427

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that **Mr. Sachin Kumar Sood S/o Mr. Jayanti Prasad Sood** intends to purchase a **plot of land measuring 25 Sq. Yards, out of Khasra No. 413, situated at Geetanjali Vihar Colony, Village Khora, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh – 201001**.
The said property is proposed to be purchased from **Mr. Mohammad Danish Malik S/o Mr. Saleem Khan**, who claims to have acquired all rights, title and interest in the said property by virtue of a **Notarized General Power of Attorney, Agreement to Sell and Will, all dated 21.04.2025**, executed by **Mr. Dhirendra Gupta S/o Mr. Ravi Prakash Gupta and Mr. Shahir S/o Mr. Yaseen**. It is further informed that the said property is proposed to be mortgaged with **Shubham Housing Development Finance Company Ltd.** for obtaining financial assistance. It is also brought to the notice of the general public that the **Surviving Member Certificate of Late Mr. Joginder Kumar** is not available with the seller and is stated to have been lost/misplaced. Any person having any claim or objection must notify the undersigned in writing within 7 days, failing which it will be presumed there are no objections.

Authorized signatory
NCR LAW ASSOCIATES
Advocate & Consultants
A-98, Sector-09, New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P-201009
Mob. Nos. 9999721152/ 9999826427

PUBLIC NOTICE

Mr. Rajinder Paul Jindal has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., DCM Building, New Delhi. (Bank) to avail a loan for purchase of Entire First Floor of Property No. 31, (401 sq. yds), Block-C, Defence Colony, New Delhi from Mr. Rakesh Oberai, who has represented that he is the absolute owner of the said floor having inherited by Will dated 16.09.2000 of his late father Mr. B.N. Oberoi & Partition Deed dated 29.03.2016 (Doc-393). Mr. B.N. Oberoi was the owner of the said entire property vide Conveyance Deed dated 10.07.2000 (Doc-7572). If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 15 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.

Amit Kumar, Advocate
Narang & Associates
D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

DISOWN NOTICE

I, Mrs. Sunit Blaggan aged about 88 years, daughter of Shri Sohan Lal Sarna, Aadhaar No. 7270 4967 8300, wife of Late Shri Kewal Krishan Blaggan, Residing at House No. 512, Sector-16, Near K. L. Mehta Dayanand School, Faridabad-121002, (Haryana) hereby declare that my Daughter in Law Ms Neeru Blaggan Aadhar No: 2534 7713 0350 DOB: 20.11.1963 and Grand Son, Mr Piyush Blaggan, Aadhar No. 7791 5825 7191 DOB: 10.10.1993 have been disowned and debarred from my movable and immovable properties with immediate effect due to their ill behaviour and continuous misconduct, habitual abuse, harassment, which has caused immense mental and physical trauma.
Accordingly, they have no concern or authority, whatsoever in respect of my self-acquired movable and immovable properties, assets, bank accounts, investments, businesses or any other belongings.
Further, I declare that I shall not be responsible for any act, omission, debt, liability, borrowing, representation, transaction or commitment made by them in any manner whatsoever. Any person dealing with them shall do so entirely at their own risk, cost and consequences. This Public Notice is issued for the information of the general public.

Sd/-
Mrs. Sunit Blaggan)
Uday Kumar, Advocate
Date: 14.10.2026
Place: Faridabad, Haryana

PUBLIC NOTICE

M/s Gurugram Commercity Limited has been granted Environmental Clearance by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India for proposed Mixed Land Use Colony Project located at Village: Fazilpur Jharsa, Sector-71, District-Gurugram, Haryana vide EC identification no. EC25B3813HR5926803N and File No. 21/172/2025-IA.III dated 29/09/2026. The copy of Environmental clearance along with the conditions to be complied with is available at office of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change IA Division, and on the website at http://parivesh.nic.in and also available at the registered office of the company at 13th Floor, Dr. Gopal Das Bhawan, 28 Barakhamba Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001 and also on website of the company at www.signatureglobal.in.

Sd/-
Authorised Signatory
For Gurugram Commercity Limited
CIN: U70100DL2019PLC348723
Address: 13th Floor, Dr. Gopal Das Bhawan, 28 Barakhamba Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to MR. HASIM MALIK S/O ALAM MALIK, R/O. H. NO. S-206, 45FT ROAD, GALI NO. 2, HINDON VIHAR, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201001, that the tenancy in respect of SHOP NO. 2, Size (9'X18') AND ONE HALL (35'X'18') Situated at H. NO RZ-48-E, B-BLOCK, OLD ROSHANPURA, MAIN CHHAWLA GURGAON ROAD, NEW CHHAWLA BUS STAND, NAJAFGARH, NEW DELHI-110043 has been terminated by the landlord on account of non-payment of rent and other outstanding dues. The outstanding amount claimed is ₹2,80,300/-, comprising rent arrears of ₹2,69,500/- and electricity charges of ₹10,800/-, besides applicable interest, damages and legal costs. The addressee is hereby called upon to clear the outstanding dues, remove his belongings and hand over peaceful vacant possession of the premises within the stipulated period mentioned in the legal notice being served through WhatsApp and Speed Post, failing which appropriate legal proceedings shall be initiated in accordance with law, at his risk as to costs and consequences.

Nitish Kumar(Advocate)
Chamber No. 143,
Patiala House Court,
New Delhi-110001
Mobile: 7503520693, 8527041080.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-I, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1	**Name of work :** Yard improvement work of various yards in DUK section under ADEN/KUN.
2	**Approx. cost of work :** Rs. 1,55,51,653.62 (Rupees One Crore Fifty Five Lakh Fifty One Thousand Six Hundred Fifty Three and Sixty Two Only)
3	**Earnest Money to be deposited :** Rs. 3,11,000.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Elevan Thousand Only)
4	**Cost of tender document :** Rs. 0.00/-
5	**Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender :** 03.11.2026 @15:00 Hrs.
6	**Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in**
7	**Allocation :** 29314103

- The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system.
- For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.
- No manual offers are acceptable.
- Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No.: 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/48/2026-27-W-I Dated:- 12.10.2026 3551/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL
ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL LIMITED
Registered Office: Indian Rayon Compound, Veraval, Gujarat - 362266.
Corporate Office : 12th Floor, R Teck Park, Nirlon Complex, Near Hub Mall, Goregaon (E), Mumbai-400 063, MH.

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

15 DAYS AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE ASSETS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISON TO RULE 9(1) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002.
On account of the amalgamation between **Aditya Birla Finance Ltd.** and **Aditya Birla Capital Ltd.** vide the Scheme of Amalgamation dated 11.03.2024 duly recorded in the Order passed by the National Company Law Tribunal-Ahmedabad on **24.03.2025**, all SARFAESI actions initiated by **Aditya Birla Finance Ltd.** in relation to the mortgaged property mentioned, stands transferred to **Aditya Birla Capital Ltd.,** the amalgamated company.
Accordingly the **Authorized Officer** of **Aditya Birla Capital Limited** / Secured Creditor had **TAKEN POSSESSION** of the following secured assets pursuant to notice issued under Sec. 13(2) of Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI) for recovery of the secured debts of the secured creditor, for the dues as mentioned herein below with further charges and cost thereon from the following Borrowers and Co-Borrowers. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrowers and Co-Borrowers that e-auction of the following property for realization of the debts due to the **Aditya Birla Capital Limited** will be held on **"As is where is", "As is what is"** and **"Whatever there is" basis.**

DATE & TIME OF E-AUCTION : 30.10.2026, BETWEEN 11:00 A. M. TO 01:00 P. M.
LAST DATE OF RECEIPT OF KYC & EARNEST MONEY DEPOSIT (EMD) : 29.10.2026

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrowers & Co-Borrowers	Description of Properties / Secured Assets	Reserve Price (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (in Rs.) / Incremental Value) (in Rs.)	Demand Notice Date & Total Amt. (in Rs.)
1.	**1. M/s. Jai Krishna Enterprises,** Through Its Proprietor **2. Mr. Atul Jain,** S/o. Mr. Rajendra Kumar Jain **3. Mrs. Alka Jain,** S/o. Mr. Atul Jain **4. Mrs. Shalini Jain,** W/o. Mr. Vikash Jain **5. Mrs. Neelam Jain,** W/o. Mr. Sandeep Jain **LAN : ABNMSTS000000825674** AND **ABNMSTS000000825953**	All that piece and parcel of The Double Stored Residential House Bearing Municipal No. 703 To 707 Having An Area Measuring 251 Sq. Mtrs. Situated At Mohalla Kalyan Singh, Jabbar Mandi, Kasba Mawana Kalan, Tehsil : Mawana, District : Meerut, Uttar Pradesh And **Bounded As - East :** Road; **West :** House of Smt. Narayani Devi; **North :** House of Smt. Sita Devi W/o. Ragubar Dayal And House of Deepak Kumar S/o. Jagdishpal Singh; **South :** House of Smt. Manto Devi W/o. Kishan Lal & House of Smt. Murtidevi W/o. Jaiprakash.	**Rs. 55,00,000/- (Rs. Fifty Five Lakhs Only).**	**Rs. 5,50,000/- (Rs. Five Lakhs Fifty Thousand Only) Rs. 25,000/- (Rs. Twenty Five Thousand Only)**	**11.11.2024 & Rs. 59,03,289.70 (Rs. Fifty Nine Lakhs Three Thousand Two Hundred Eighty Nine and Seventy Paisa Only)** As On **11.11.2024**

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in **Aditya Birla Capital Limited** / Secured Creditor's website i. e. **https://abfl.adityabirlacapital.com/Pages/Individual/Properties-for-Auction-under-SARFAESI-Act.aspx** or **https://BidDeal.in** Contact Nos.: **Ashish Srivastava (9696515559), Parneet Singh (9720029337), Apoorva Danthi (9930909725), Ved Prakash Mishra (9004026790), Mohit Sharma (9873913955), Komal Patil (9867895795), Jahirul Laskar (9706003075).**
Place : Meerut, Uttar Pradesh, **Date :** 14.10.2026
Sd/- Authorised Officer, **Aditya Birla Capital Limited**

Although every possible care and caution has been taken to avoid errors or omissions, this publication is being sold on the condition and understanding that information given in this publication is merely for reference and must not be taken as having authority of or binding in any way on the writers, editors, publishers, and printers and sellers who do not owe any responsibility for any damage or loss to any person, a purchaser of this publication or not for the result of any action taken on the basis of this work. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent court and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only. Readers are advised and requested to verify and seek appropriate advice to satisfy themselves about the veracity of any kind of advertisement before responding to any contents published in this newspaper. The printer, publisher, editor and any employee of the Pioneer Group's will not be held responsible for any kind of claim made by the advertisers of the products & services and shall not be made responsible for any kind of loss, consequences and further product-related damages on such advertisements.

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

CJP leaders scale gate at Jantar Mantar, detained by police

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

The entrance to Jantar Mantar became the first point of confrontation on Tuesday morning. Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das and Ajinkya Shinde, leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), climbed over a gate and entered the protest site with party volunteers. They carried the national flag and raised slogans before Delhi Police personnel moved in and detained them. The brief entry was an attempt to reclaim a site that police had recently removed from the list of designated protest venues.

The three leaders had returned to the site after the authorities withdrew its designation as an authorised venue for demonstrations. Police had instead designated Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground and CBD Ground in east Delhi for future protests. For the CJP, however, the dispute was no longer simply about where a demonstration could be held. The party's leaders were attempting to establish a physical presence at Jantar Mantar despite the restrictions.

The entry did not last long. Police detained the leaders and other volunteers shortly after they crossed the gate. Saurav Das subsequently declared on social media that Jantar Mantar had been reclaimed. The police action brought the immediate demonstration to an end, but the restrictions on the site continued to shape the day's protests elsewhere in the Capital.

"You cannot denotify resistance," CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke asserted, tagging Prime Minister Narendra Modi, as the outfit described its action as reclaiming Jantar Mantar and their right to protest.


CJP leader Ashutosh Ranka and other workers wave the national flag at Jantar Mantar before being detained by police in New Delhi PTI

"Fortress Jantar Mantar has been reclaimed," said a CJP statement, noting that its members had entered the heavily barricaded site and "hoisted the Tricolour" there.

According to the CJP, around 11 of its members, including Ranka, Das and Ajinkya Shinde, were detained on Tuesday. A senior police officer, requesting anonymity, said Das, Ranka and some other protesters were taken to Jaffarpur Kalan Police Station in Dwarka district after being detained.

He also shared a video showing CJP members running towards the heavily barricaded protest site, scaling a gate and raising slogans while holding a tricolour, before being held by police personnel. They shouted slogans like "*Bharat Mata ki Jai*" and demanded CEC Kumar's resignation. Later, in a post, he said the CJP leaders remained in detention and claimed their lawyers were not being allowed to meet them.

On Tuesday, the police response extended beyond the immediate protest site. The previous days' restrictions had affected movement through central Delhi, while the authorities continued to monitor locations where demonstrators might assemble. The dispute over Jantar Mantar had therefore acquired a wider geographical footprint: activists were attempting to gather, police were intervening to prevent assemblies, and demonstrators were looking for alternative places to make their presence felt.

Later, a group of protesters associated with student organisation DISHA and the Revolutionary Workers Party emerged from Janpath Metro station and marched towards Connaught Place, protesting the de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a protest venue. The demonstrators were detained by Delhi Police. Their march formed part of the wider mobilisation by student groups and activists against the restrictions on demonstrations and the police action against protesters.

The day's events also followed a broader clampdown on demonstrations in the capital. Earlier in the week, police had deployed personnel and barricades at multiple locations to prevent protesters from reaching Jantar Mantar. Small groups had attempted to assemble at different points, including near Connaught Place and Parliament Street, where police detained demonstrators.

By Tuesday, the protests had become a contest over both the demand being raised and the space in which it could be raised. The CJP's attempt to enter Jantar Mantar ended in detention. Accounts from earlier detainees brought scrutiny to the treatment of protesters after arrest. Meanwhile, the INDIA bloc's leaders were turning to meetings and a joint public statement to decide how to continue their campaign.

The result was a day of parallel developments rather than a single continuous march: an attempted return to Jantar Mantar, continuing questions about police detentions, and an opposition gathering intended to coordinate the next phase of its political response.

CASE REGISTERED OVER TRESPASSING

Delhi Police have registered a case of trespassing after members of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) allegedly breached security restrictions to enter Jantar Mantar on Tuesday, police sources said. The sections invoked and the names of those booked were not immediately available.

Reports said CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka, Saurav Das and Ajinkya Shinde were among about 20 volunteers detained after they climbed over a gate and barricades to reach the site. A video posted by the group showed volunteers waving the national flag and raising slogans before police arrived and took them away. Police did not immediately comment on the detentions.

Police seek extension of CAPF deployment till October 20

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Police has asked the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) to remain in the city until October 20 due to possible protests over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. According to sources, they want 273 CAPF companies to stay after the previous deployment ended on Monday. Earlier, 301 companies were approved - 221 on October 6 and 80 more on October 8. Of those 80, 28 had not arrived by Monday.

The request to the Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) highlights the need to maintain law and order at key sites like Jantar Mantar, the Election Commission, Parliament House, and India Gate.

Protesters have targeted Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and raised concerns about problems in the revision process in parts of Delhi. Groups like the Cockroach Janta Party, the Bhim Army, student organisations, and other political groups have been involved. Over the weekend, the city had heavy security, with many officers on duty, 45 metro stations closed, and strict border checks.



Authorities detained thousands of protesters, including leaders from the Cockroach Janta Party and former chief ministers. As a result, the capital took on a fortified atmosphere as officials prepared for more protests.

Updating electoral rolls is a regular process meant to keep voter lists accurate by removing ineligible names and adding new ones. When done quickly or on a large scale, it can spark arguments about who is included or left out and whether the process is fair. In a crowded city with many political groups, these updates often lead to organised protests.

Demonstrations at well-known places let people express their views and put pressure on officials. Police talk about the 'possibility of protests' and 'potential situations' as part of their usual planning, especially when protests have already happened, and more could follow.

Bringing in more CAPF forces is a common way for Indian cities to handle large or multiple public gatherings. These companies give officials a flexible team that can move between locations, so local police are not stretched too thin. The fact that hundreds of companies were called shows authorities expected protests at several key locations, possibly at the same time. Some companies not arriving on time highlights the challenges of moving so many people quickly.

FIRs filed over protest rumours, Pak handles scanned

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Police has registered four FIRs against social media handles allegedly spreading false narratives and rumours regarding the protests in the Capital, with several Pakistan-based social media handles under the scanner.

Cases have been registered against social media handles allegedly disseminating misleading information, attempting to create an "anti-India narrative" and disturb law and order, they said. According to a police source, several social media handles based in Pakistan are allegedly involved in spreading anti-India narratives in connection with the protests through posts and claims that could create unrest.



On October 10, several such handles allegedly circulated false claims that multiple people died during the Delhi protests, officials said.

Police have got several Pakistan-based social media handles deactivated as part of the action against the alleged "misinformation campaign", they added.

Delhi Police is monitoring various social media platforms to curb spread of misinformation in the wake of protests in the capital, with around 500 posts allegedly aimed at spreading rumours or creating public unrest taken down, police sources said.On Monday, Delhi Police warned of strict legal action against a social media handle for a post allegedly spreading misinformation about police firing during the INDIA bloc's rally towards Supreme Court.

The post in question claimed that Delhi Police had opened fire at the rally, killing five, and urged people to come out on the streets and block Delhi.

In a post on X, Delhi Police said the handle @indiantiwari01 had a documented history of sharing doctored media, old footage and fabricated narratives to mislead the public.

"Do not fall for or amplify this rumour," police said, adding that spreading malicious rumours on social media was a punishable offence and strict legal action would be initiated against the handle.

The police have also approached social media platform X seeking the removal of objectionable and allegedly misleading content linked to the protests, sources said.

The social media monitoring exercise is aimed at identifying fabricated content, misleading claims and posts that could potentially disturb public order, they added.

Police teams are scanning online platforms, while further action is being taken against content found to be spreading misinformation or attempting to incite unrest, sources said.

Man beaten to death at club over spilled beer, five people arrested

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Five people, including bouncers, a club manager and his wife, were arrested for the death of a man who was allegedly assaulted by the couple and the staff for spilling beer on the woman at a nightclub in New Delhi. The incident took place late on October 10 at Tor House nightclub near Ashok Park Metro station under the Sarai Rohilla police station area, they said. Among the five, three bouncers have also been arrested.

The deceased, identified as Daljeet, was a resident of Raghuvir Nagar and is survived by his wife Pooja, an eight-year-old son and his father.

According to the police, Daljeet had gone to the nightclub with five to six of his friends for a party when some liquid spilt on the wife of the club manager. A verbal altercation broke out, following which bouncers were called and Daljeet was allegedly assaulted.



Daljeet and his friends apologised and requested them to stop, but they kept assaulting the group with sticks and glass bottles.

Friends of the deceased told mediapersons that the attackers continued thrashing Daljeet despite repeated pleas to spare him. "We were thrashed brutally," one of the friends, Sunny, who sustained a minor head injury, said.

They alleged that when the group tried to escape, the bouncers dragged them back inside and assaulted them again.

According to his friends, the attackers also poured water on them during the assault after covering his face. Daljeet sustained severe injuries, including a fractured jaw, and was in a bad state.

His friends, including Nishu and Pawan, somehow managed to take him out of the club and brought him to his residence in Raghuvir Nagar. Daljeet collapsed near the entrance of his house, after which his wife and friends took him to Guru Gobind Singh Hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

Police said Daljeet had returned home after the assault and was feeling unwell. His wife subsequently took him to the hospital, where he was declared dead. Sunny further said that he received a call from the deceased's wife after the incident.

"I am his friend. I got a call from his wife. That he was not moving and we rushed him to the hospital, where he was declared dead," Sunny said. He added that "We have seen the CCTV footage and it was horrific. Daljeet was thrashed brutally. Those who did this to him must be strictly punished."

Why is there a tent outside?: Son asks slain driver's wife

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

An eight-year-old boy, still waiting for his father to return home, asked his mother why a tent had been erected outside their house. His mother, inconsolable after losing her husband in an alleged assault by nightclub bouncers, had no answer for him.

"He hugs me and cries, asking for his father. What do I tell him now? He keeps asking why there is a tent outside our house. I just cried and told him it was not ours," Pooja, wife of 29-year-old Daljeet, said, breaking down as she recounted the family's loss.

Daljeet, a driver, died after allegedly being brutally assaulted by bouncers and the manager of a nightclub in north Delhi following a dispute over beer spilling on the manager's wife, police said.

Five people, including the club manager, his wife and three bouncers have been arrested in connection with the incident that took place late Saturday at Tor House nightclub near Ashok Park Metro station, under the Sarai Rohilla police station area.


Representational image

Daljeet, a resident of Raghuvir Nagar, is survived by his wife, their eight-year-old son and his father. Daljeet was the sole breadwinner of his house.

Recounting the last hours of her husband's life, Pooja said she repeatedly tried calling him but his phone was unreachable. "I was about to leave the house to look for him when I went downstairs and saw him lying on the ground, seriously injured. I helped him get upstairs, changed his clothes and let him sleep. When I checked on him in the morning, he was unconscious," she said. She alleged that her husband had been brutally beaten using sticks and blows aimed at his head and jaw.

"He was beaten mercilessly and drowned in water repeatedly. They hit him on his head and jaw. They used sticks and blows to kill him. He died at home," she alleged.

Pooja said the family was now struggling to explain the tragedy to their young son. "When we were taking him to the hospital, my son made me promise that I would bring his father home safely. I told him his father was in the hospital. What do I tell him now?" she said, tears rolling down her face.

JNU issues proctorial notice to JNUSU president Aditi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Jawaharlal Nehru University has issued a notice to a PhD student, directing her to appear before a proctorial committee on October 22 over allegations of manhandling security personnel and damaging property on campus, amid an ongoing hunger strike by students.

The notice, dated October 9, asks Aditi Mishra, president of the JNU Students' Union (JNUSU), to appear for a hearing at 3 pm in the administrative building and explain her position.

According to the notice, the Chief Proctor's office received a complaint alleging that Mishra had manhandled and misbehaved with security personnel and broken glass panes at the main gate of the Inter-Hall Administration (IHA) main gate and a window on September 8.

She has been asked to bring any evidence she wishes to submit in her defence. The notice also states that the matter may be decided in her absence if she fails to appear for the hearing.

It further mentions that Mishra has been rusticated and declared out of bounds from the campus under an office order dated February 2, and directs her to report to the security office at the north gate at 2:30 pm on October 22, from where security personnel will escort her to the Chief Proctor's office.

JNU students claimed that at least 10-12 other students had also received similar notices in connection with a protest held on September 8.

There was no immediate response from the university administration, and the number of notices issued could not be independently confirmed.

Delhi University approves ₹5,889 crore mega plan to expand student hostels

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Delhi University has approved a ₹5,889 crore proposal to expand residential facilities for 21,895 students through the construction of new hostels and reconstruction of two existing ones.

The proposal was approved at the 1284th meeting of the Executive Council, chaired by Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh.

According to the proposal passed by the ECI, new hostels will be constructed at an estimated cost of ₹4,027 crore, providing additional accommodation for 15,758 students. Additionally, a proposal to reconstruct two existing hostels was passed, with an estimated cost of ₹1,862 crore; this will provide residential facilities for 6,137 students.

Additional multi-storey hostel buildings are planned at the university's Dhaka Complex, Surajmal Vihar campus and Najafgarh campus. The Dhaka Complex accounts for the largest share of the proposed construction. The university has proposed two Y-shaped hostel buildings, one for male students and the other for female students, each with a capacity of 4,836 residents.

Both projects are estimated to cost around ₹1,130 crore each. The plan also includes dedicated accommodation for working women and women students at the Dhaka Complex. Two facilities, each with a proposed capacity of 1,674 residents, are planned at an estimated cost of ₹400 crore per project. Another undergraduate hostel with a capacity of 3,162 students has been proposed at the Dhaka Complex, with an estimated cost of ₹678 crore.

Outside the Dhaka Complex, the proposed projects include a hostel facility at the East Campus in Surajmal Vihar, which is expected to accommodate 2,340 students at a cost of ₹725 crore. Hostels at Najafgarh and the West Campus are also planned, with a combined capacity of 2,072 students and an estimated expenditure of ₹694 crore.

Hostels for male and female students will also be constructed at Veer Savarkar College in Roshanpura, Najafgarh; at the university's West Campus in Dwarka; and at the East Campus in Surajmal Vihar, Karkardooma. The proposed hostel complexes will include dining halls, shops, common rooms, reading rooms and residences for wardens.



Alongside new construction, DU plans to redevelop existing hostel facilities to increase their capacity. The proposed reconstruction projects are expected to provide accommodation to more than 10,000 students. The iconic Jubilee Hall Hostel is proposed to be demolished and replaced with a 32-storey building that can accommodate around 3,800 students. The project is estimated to cost ₹1,225.59 crore. The university has also proposed reconstructing the PG Men's Hostel as a high-rise building with accommodation for approximately 2,337 students. The International Student House is another facility identified for redevelopment. The proposed reconstructed building is expected to accommodate around 3,300 students.

Responding to a query, Singh clarified that the names of any existing hostels would not be changed upon their reconstruction. Singh said that the names of Jubilee Hall and the PG Men's Hostel would remain unchanged after their reconstruction.

Singh said the designs for the buildings had been prepared keeping the needs of the 21st century in mind, with planning undertaken from a long-term perspective. He said the circumstances under which the university's existing hostels were built were different from those expected in the future, and the new infrastructure was being planned with the next 100 years in view.

Given the scarcity of vacant land on the university's campuses, the Executive Council decided that hostel blocks would be designed to make maximum use of the permissible Floor Area Ratio (FAR). These blocks will also include amenities such as dining halls, shops, common rooms, reading rooms, and warden residences. Hostel complexes across the three campuses have been planned with these requirements in mind.

The Executive Council urged colleges to prepare proposals for constructing hostels on their respective campuses and submit them to the funding agency.

The proposed expansion comes amid concerns about the limited availability of affordable, safe accommodation for Delhi University students. The university has more than 2.5 lakh students, while its existing hostel facilities can house only a small proportion of the total student population. As a result, many students, particularly those arriving in Delhi from other states, depend on private paying guest accommodation, rented rooms and shared flats. Housing costs, availability and safety remain important considerations for students seeking admission to colleges across the university.

The issue has drawn renewed attention following the September 6 collapse of a paying guest accommodation building in Satya Niketan, Delhi. The incident brought into focus concerns about the safety of private residential facilities used by students.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

No MDR hike on UPI fee from October 15

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



In a major relief to UPI users, the decision to levy a 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on transactions over ₹2,000 was deferred on Tuesday, with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) saying it will decide a new date after Diwali. It was originally scheduled to take effect from October 15.

"UPI and Services Steering Committee on Tuesday decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, MDR on select Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions shall be implemented immediately post Diwali on a date to be notified separately," NPCI said in a statement. The MDR has to be paid by merchants, not consumers, and capped at ₹300 for transactions of ₹75,000 or more.

The decision to defer came amid allegations by the Opposition, which termed it a tax and said the levy on specified UPI transactions above ₹2,000 would burden consumers. As per the circular dated September 15, payments between individuals, as well as the vast majority of everyday merchant payments, were to remain free.

Essential services, such as railways, telecom, fuel, and insurance, were to attract a flat ₹5 fee per transaction above ₹2,000. Capital markets transactions (mutual funds, stockbroking) were to get a lower 0.02 per cent rate, also capped at ₹300.

The National Payments Corporation, which operates the UPI platform, decided to levy MDR on certain UPI transactions to create a sustainable revenue framework for the digital payments ecosystem. According to NPCI, it will share the collected amount among banks and other entities in the UPI ecosystem. Of the MDR collected, 40 per cent will go to customers' banks, 30 per cent to payment gateways, 20 per cent to the UPI app and the remaining 10 per cent to the sponsoring bank of the UPI app.

Welcoming the decision, the Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT) said the government's move to defer the proposed MDR charges on UPI transactions is "timely and pragmatic", particularly during the crucial festive and wedding season, when millions of traders and MSMEs depend on higher business volumes.

"Additional transaction costs could have placed an avoidable burden on merchants operating on thin margins and discouraged the wider acceptance of digital payments," CAIT said.

It shared that the decision follows the meeting held on September 30, 2026, when a delegation of around 20 trade leaders met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and highlighted the implications of the proposed 0.4 per cent MDR on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000.

Complaint filed over knife attack bid on Mamata near home

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kolkata



A complaint was filed with the police alleging that a woman carrying a knife attempted to approach former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee in a threatening manner when she was going to inaugurate a Durga Puja near her residence in the city's Kalighat area.

The accused woman was detained, a senior police officer said. In the complaint, Mamata AITC leader Dola Sen alleged that the incident took place around 6 pm on Tuesday when Banerjee visited the Milan Sangha Puja pandal in her neighbourhood.

The complaint named the woman and alleged that she was known in the locality as a civic volunteer and a drug addict."She was hurling abuses and, in an intoxicated manner, tried to violently approach Mamata Banerjee," Sen said in the complaint, adding that the woman was carrying a knife. The complaint further alleged that the woman claimed to be Banerjee's niece and lay on the road, creating a scene while attempting to approach the Mamata AITC supremo.

Sen said it was concerning that someone allegedly carrying a weapon could approach the residence of Banerjee, a Z-plus category protectee. Stating that the incident could be the result of a conspiracy, the former Rajya Sabha member requested the police to examine photographs and video footage submitted with the complaint and take appropriate legal action. She urged the authorities to take cognisance of the matter under Section 173 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which governs how police record information regarding cognisable offences.

ED arrests two operatives in Salim Dhola's international Mephedrone

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Mumbai

The Enforcement Directorate's (ED) Mumbai Zonal Office has arrested Praveen alias Nagesh Ramchandra Shinde and Brijesh Kanajibhai Moradia under Section 19 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002, in connection with laundering proceeds generated by an international organised narcotics trafficking network run by Salim Ismail Dhola and his associates.

The probe originates from multiple First Information Reports (FIRs) registered by various police stations under the Kanpur Division of Mumbai Police against Salim Dhola and others for the illegal trafficking of prohibited narcotic and psychotropic substances.

ED investigations have established the existence of a highly structured cross-border crime network engaged in the clandestine purchase of precursors, illegal manufacture of Mephedrone (MD), international trafficking and distribution of the drug, hawala-based movement of funds, collection of illegal income



in the names of close associates, and acquisition of immovable properties.

Praveen alias Nagesh Ramchandra Shinde has been identified as a key figure in the illegal clandestine manufacture of Mephedrone and its subsequent sale and supply. ED says he was involved in generating, managing, utilising, and transferring the proceeds of this illicit trade.

The illegal income was channelled through bank accounts opened in the names of his close associates and other persons to conceal its origin and ownership. Brijesh Moradia handled the procurement and supply chain of precursors required for the illegal manufacture of MD.

He allegedly received large volumes of cash from Angola, which were deposited into bank accounts held by him, his associates, and controlled entities. These funds were then routed through banking and hawala channels to various chemical companies and institutions for the purchase of precursors. In return,

Moradia and his relatives received commissions in the form of chemicals, which were later transferred, sold, and used in the manufacturing process. On June 2 and June 3, 2026, the ED conducted coordinated search operations at 21 locations across Mumbai, Surat, Ankleshwar and Rajkot.

The searches covered the entire operational network of the Salim Dhola syndicate, including key persons and premises linked to precursor suppliers, chemical traders, manufacturers, distributors of synthetic drugs, and entities holding proceeds of crime. During the raids, officials seized cash amounting to approximately ₹1.33 crore, foreign currency including $2,200, gold biscuits, and other valuables. Officials also recovered documents related to immovable properties valued at crores of rupees in India and Dubai, indicating investment of proceeds generated by the syndicate.

FROM PAGE - 1

Shah to Rahul: Brace for 2029 rout

Shah further argued that Gandhi was dismissing the BJP and Modi's popularity by attributing outcomes to the SIR exercise. He pointed to the Congress's long-term decline in a major State where the party once held power, observing that it has failed to win a single election there in 41 years. "This demands serious introspection on their part," he said.

To underscore his point, Shah cited recent by-elections held in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, and Puducherry. He stated that the Congress failed to win a single seat in any of these contests. In Nagaon, the BJP candidate defeated the Congress by 1,42,000 votes and wrested the seat. In Nandigram, the BJP candidate secured 76 per cent of the vote and won by 1,22,000 votes. In Rejinagar in West Bengal, the BJP won by more than 75,000 votes, taking the seat from the Trinamool Congress. In Puducherry, the NDA candidate from ally AINRC won by 8,482 votes, while the Congress got only 22 per cent of the vote.

Shah made these comments while the Opposition continues to criticise the Election Commission and the SIR process, which parties like the Congress claim is being used to disenfranchise voters. The Home Minister pointed to the by-election results and Congress's overall electoral record as proof that the party's confrontational approach is not connecting with voters. He said the NDA's strong position shows that people support the government's work, not that the electoral rolls are being manipulated.

Shah linked Gandhi's leadership to a series of defeats and pointed out that Congress has not won any recent by-elections. He argued that the Opposition's protests are meant to distract from its own organisational and political problems. Shah repeated that Congress should reflect on its own actions, rather than what he called negative politics, if it wants to win back public trust before the next general election.

The statements reinforce the ruling alliance's view that election results still favour the NDA, and that questioning the Election Commission does not change the main political situation. Shah's direct message to Gandhi and his colleagues to get ready for another loss in 2029 showed the BJP's confidence in its path and its belief that the Opposition has little chance of winning.

SIR row: Supreme Court defers hearing...

The bench also issued notice on a fresh petition filed by NGO Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) challenging Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act.

The Supreme Court also agreed to hear on October 15 a plea seeking a complete ban on political demonstrations within the court premises and contempt proceedings against political leaders who obstruct the judicial system.

During the hearing, the CJI informed the petitioners that Justice Mohana was unwell but still came to the court. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta urged the bench to adjourn the hearing, saying the bench should not ignore health issues. Other senior advocates, including Gopal Sankaranarayanan, also agreed to the deferment.

Mehta told the bench that the time granted to the Centre to file its response on the plea alleging contempt for disobeying the apex court's direction not to completely halt metro and train services ahead of the October 10 protest was till Tuesday.

The bench extended the time to file the affidavit and said the same be supplied to the counsel appearing for the petitioners. Besides the Solicitor General and Sankaranarayanan, senior advocates Menaka Guruswamy, Arundhati Katju, CU Singh, Nitya Ramakrishnan and Indira Jaising appeared in the proceedings.

The provision grants immunity to the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners for certain acts undertaken in the discharge of their official duties. ADR has challenged the constitutional validity of the provision.

RJD Rajya Sabha MP Manoj Jha also approached the top court, alleging disproportionate use of force, illegal detention and house arrest of protesters, students, lawyers and political leaders, as well as sexual harassment of women protesters. The Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association has sought an independent, impartial and time-bound inquiry into the alleged illegal detention and manhandling of lawyers by Delhi Police during the October 10 protest march. The Supreme Court Bar Association has also approached the court over the alleged manhandling and detention of lawyers near the Supreme Court.

Rahul vows to continue fight for democracy

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Congress Parliamentary Party (CPP) chairperson Sonia Gandhi and several opposition leaders, including Tejashwi Yadav and Manoj Jha of the RJD, Mahua Maji (JMM), Harender Malik, Anand Bhadauria and Mohibullah Nadvi (SP), MA Baby (CPI-M), D Raja and P Sandosh Kumar (CPI), AISA chief Neha Bora, Dipankar Bhattacharya (CPI-ML) and Mahua Moitra (TMC), attended the tea at Rahul Gandhi's 5, Sunehri Bagh Road, residence.

The LoP also said it deeply respects the Supreme Court and the Chief Justice of India (CJI) and hoped they would play their role in this process. "We have extreme respect for the Supreme Court, for the Chief Justice of India, for the judicial system. They have a role to play; we hope they will.

He said that it is not simple that some "destroy" India's Constitution and get away with it, and assured people of action against those who have indulged in "vote chori".

"It is our commitment that the people who have done this -- Mr Modi, who is the main architect, Amit Shah, who is the implementer, Gyanesh Kumar and others -- they need to understand that the net is closing around them... We assure you that all would be brought to justice," he asserted.

The former Congress chief also thanked people for participating in the massive protest on the streets, after they participated in the protest march to the Supreme Court. He asserted that what they saw during the Monday protest was "an expression not of political parties standing here, but of the people of India".

IMF raises India's FY27 growth forecast to 7%

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday hailed the IMF projection of 7 per cent GDP growth for India in 2027, adding that the country's multiple Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) are expected to boost global economic activity and "build resilient supply chains."

"UNSTOPPABLE INDIA! The IMF has projected 7% GDP growth for Bharat in 2027, making us among the fastest-growing major economies. Our multiple FTAs under PM @NarendraModi ji are also expected to positively contribute to global economic activity and build resilient supply chains," Goyal said in a post on social media. Despite the growth upgrade, India still faces risks from higher commodity prices and external imbalances. The IMF projects India's consumer inflation at 5 per cent in FY27, compared with 2 per cent in FY26, before moderating to 4.4 per cent in FY28. India's inflation climbed to 5.5 per cent in September, the highest level in the new series.

India's current account deficit is projected to widen to 1.5 per cent of GDP in FY27 from 0.7 per cent in FY26, before narrowing to 1.3 per cent in FY28. The IMF has become more optimistic about some major advanced economies. Germany is now expected to grow by 1.3 per cent in 2026, up from the 0.7 per cent forecast made in July.

The UK's growth forecast has also risen to 1.3 per cent from 1 per cent. China's growth trajectory is projected to weaken further. After expanding by 5% in 2025, the country's economy is forecast to grow by 4.5% in 2026 and 4% in 2027. Overall, advanced economies are now projected to grow by 2.1 per cent in 2026, up from the 1.7 per cent rate estimated in July.

Higher oil prices, subdued domestic demand and persistent structural headwinds are among the factors weighing on the outlook. The global outlook remains vulnerable to further disruptions in oil supplies, renewed trade tensions and tighter financial conditions, even as India continues to demonstrate relatively strong growth momentum.

Murugan resigns, leaves RS also

Murugan has been a member of the Rajya Sabha since September 2021 and was re-elected to the Upper House in April 2024 from Madhya Pradesh. His tenure ends in April 2030. The minister said he wants to resign his Rajya Sabha seat.

The BJP also did not renominate Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri in the just-concluded Rajya Sabha elections from Uttar Pradesh. However, he remains a member of the Union Cabinet.

Similarly, MoS in the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, BL Verma, was also not renominated for the polls to the Upper House. He too continues to be in office. Two other MoS, Pankaj Chaudhary and Harsh Malhotra, who were made chief of the BJP's Uttar Pradesh and Delhi units, respectively, in recent months, continue to discharge both responsibilities.

"I requested our Prime Minister to relieve me from the Council of Ministers and the Rajya Sabha because I want to go to Tamil Nadu to strengthen our party. In my letter to the Prime Minister, I stated that I want to strengthen our party by going to villages, streets and everywhere else, and prepare the ground for the 2029 parliamentary elections," Murugan told the media.

In his letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Murugan, Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs, said it was the "greatest honour" of his life to serve "Bharat Mata" and Tamil Nadu under his leadership.

2 Maldivian pilots held in Flydubai probe

The flight was carrying 174 passengers and crew members from Dubai to Tel Aviv when the incident occurred. Despite sustaining serious injuries, Machchhar reportedly resisted the attack and managed to unlock the cockpit door, allowing other crew members and passengers to intervene and overpower the co-pilot.

The aircraft subsequently made an emergency landing at Tabuk airport in Saudi Arabia.

Maldivian authorities say the two detained pilots may have had professional contact with al-Hammami and lived in the same residential building. However, officials have not confirmed the nature of these alleged connections or released evidence establishing any involvement by the two men.

According to local reports, the detained individuals are among six Maldivian nationals working as pilots for Flydubai and are the airline's latest recruits from the Maldives.

Maldivian authorities have declined to comment publicly on the case, while UAE officials have yet to provide detailed information about the allegations against the detained pilots. The UAE has described the incident as an attempted terrorist attack and said al-Hammami was suspected of supporting extremist ideologies. Authorities have also said Omani officials previously prevented him from obtaining a pilot's licence. Investigators are examining how al-Hammami was recruited by the airline despite the reported restriction, along with the motive behind the alleged attack and any possible involvement of other individuals. The UAE Attorney General has said the investigation is being conducted in coordination with regional security agencies to establish the full circumstances of the incident.

India has launched a separate investigation into the alleged conspiracy. The National Investigation Agency has registered a case under the Anti-Hijacking Act and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act in connection with the attack on Machchhar.

India's Ministry of External Affairs earlier said Machchhar was responding well to treatment after undergoing surgery at a hospital in Abu Dhabi. The Indian Embassy in the UAE has remained in contact with his family, medical team and local authorities.

Investigations in the UAE and India are continuing, with authorities seeking to establish the circumstances surrounding the alleged mid-air attack, examine the suspect's background and determine whether the incident involved a wider network. The allegations against the two detained Maldivian pilots have not yet been publicly established.

India is the Mother of Democracy: PM

He emphasised that in the modern social media era, the nation's half-a-billion YouTube and Instagram users engage in robust, open debates, proving that digital power is actively fueling democratic discourse."In present times, what has played a major role in this is digital power," observed Modi.

Addressing the summit's core focus on emerging global powers, the Prime Minister highlighted a monumental paradigm shift in the 21st century's third decade, where technology, data, knowledge, and innovation have become the ultimate metrics of power.

He challenged the audience to reconsider the fundamental purpose of this power, asking whether it should elevate a select few or democratise opportunities for millions, emphasising a shift from controlling to enabling and from competing to collaborating.

He stressed that understanding this profound purpose of power is essential for navigating today's complex global dynamics. "Meaning, the true value of Power lies in its Purpose," affirmed Modi.

Elaborating upon the country's economic growth, Modi said it was anchored in strong fundamentals, financial resilience and a sustained reform drive, pitching the country as a global economic and technology power that seeks to help other nations prosper rather than grow at their expense. Modi cited the 7.8 per cent economic growth recorded in the April-June quarter, foreign-exchange reserves exceeding USD 700 billion and reforms spanning taxation, insolvency and labour laws as evidence of India's resilience. "In a world filled with uncertainty, India offers the assurance of reliability and stability," he said. He highlighted India's digital public infrastructure, affordable mobile data, digital payments and direct transfers of government benefits as examples of technology widening access to economic opportunities.

He said India is also sharing its digital public infrastructure expertise with partner countries, particularly in the Global South, citing the open-source CoWIN platform developed during the COVID-19 pandemic. Modi presented the initiative as part of a broader effort to make India's technological capabilities available beyond its borders. On poverty reduction, Modi said India had lifted 25 crore people out of poverty over the past decade, pointing to technology-enabled welfare transfers and the government's digital identity and payments infrastructure as contributors to more efficient delivery of public assistance.

He argued that India's role as a supplier of affordable medicines, a source of skilled talent, and a provider of digital infrastructure offers an alternative rooted in cooperation. Modi also cited India's vaccine supply to more than 100 countries during the pandemic as an example of using domestic manufacturing capacity to meet international needs.

Clean energy formed another pillar of his argument. Modi said India had achieved its target of sourcing 40 per cent of installed electricity capacity from non-fossil fuels in November 2021, well ahead of its 2030 deadline under the Paris climate pledge. He said renewable-energy capacity rose from about 75 gigawatts in 2014 to about 300 gigawatts.

He also highlighted the PM Surya Ghar and PM-KUSUM schemes, which support household solar adoption and solar energy generation by farmers. He said such programmes could reduce emissions, lower costs, and create economic opportunities.

When protests empty the streets, businesses pay...

Outside Statesman House, the relative quiet offered little indication of the crowds that had gathered in central Delhi on Monday for the Opposition INDIA bloc's march towards the Supreme Court. The demonstration, held amid the dispute over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls and demands for Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, brought police barricades and movement restrictions across parts of the area.

For shopkeepers, however, the immediate concern was not the political argument but the customers who had stayed away. The timing has added to their concerns, with Diwali approaching and retailers hoping to benefit from seasonal purchases. At Kake Da Hotel, a staff member reported a noticeable fall in business on Monday. The protest and the uncertainty surrounding access to the market had kept customers away, the employee said.

The effect was also visible among people who depend on passing customers rather than established storefronts. Roadside vendors selling mobile-phone covers, socks and handkerchiefs were wary of discussing the protests. Some appeared concerned that speaking to a reporter might draw the attention of municipal officials or the police and lead to their goods being confiscated.

Their hesitation reflected another vulnerability in the commercial ecosystem around Connaught Place. Small vendors working from pavements have limited financial buffers and can lose a substantial part of their daily income when the flow of pedestrians declines. Unlike larger businesses, they may have little capacity to absorb repeated interruptions.

A sweet seller outside Statesman House described a similar problem. His stock of gulab jamun, rasgulla and halwa usually sells through by evening. Monday's weak sales, however, left him with sweets that were no longer fresh enough to offer customers. He had to wait for a new batch to replenish his stock. Asked whether he considered the protest justified, the vendor redirected the question to a practical conclusion: whatever its political merits, the disruption hurt his business.

Brijesh Goyal of the Chamber of Trade and Industry estimated that the disruption had caused losses of around Rs 2,000 crore across Delhi over three days. The estimate covered a broad range of businesses, including shops, petrol pumps, hotels and restaurants, and could not be independently verified. Goyal said the uncertainty over road access and public transport had discouraged people from visiting markets. When customers cannot be sure they will reach their destination without getting caught in traffic restrictions, many postpone shopping or avoid the journey altogether. The consequences extend beyond the businesses located immediately beside a protest route.

During the farmers' agitation against the three central farm laws, blockades at Delhi's Singhu, Tikri, Ghazipur and Chilla borders affected the movement of goods and people. In November 2020, reduced supplies of fruit and vegetables from Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir affected wholesale markets in Delhi. Traders reported that arrivals at Azadpur Mandi had fallen by nearly half, while transport delays and higher freight costs pushed up wholesale prices for some seasonal produce.

The Confederation of All India Traders subsequently estimated in January 2021 that the agitation had caused business losses of around Rs 50,000 crore in Delhi-NCR. That figure was an estimate by the traders' body rather than an independently audited assessment, but it reflected the scale of concern among businesses dependent on uninterrupted transport links.

The anti-CAA agitation also exposed the economic consequences of prolonged disruption. At Shaheen Bagh in early 2020, traders said sales fell as a road blockade restricted access to the local market. Reports at the time said around 300 retail shops, showrooms, offices and restaurants had remained closed or been affected by the disruption. Some traders estimated that losses across the market ran into crores, while businesses in other sectors reported fewer customers amid protests, violence and prohibitory orders in several cities.

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No safe haven to terrorists: Shah to BIMSTEC

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi



Union Home Minister Amit Shah poses for a group photograph with delegates during the first Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) Home Ministers Meeting in New Delhi PTI

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday pressed for stronger regional cooperation among Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) countries to combat terrorism, disrupt terrorist financing and organised crime, and ensure that no terrorist network finds a haven in the region.

Addressing the grouping's first Home Ministers' Meeting here, Shah said India follows a zero-tolerance policy towards terrorism. He added that the trust underlying the BIMSTEC partnership is strengthened by the belief that each member country's security arrangements should contribute to the security of the others.

Shah called for a collective resolve to prevent terrorist networks from finding shelter, establishing bases and training facilities, mobilising resources or conducting activities against other member countries. He urged all members to cooperate on mutual legal assistance and extradition under their national laws and applicable agreements, saying such cooperation will strengthen efforts to bring criminals to justice.

Highlighting counterterrorism and law enforcement as key areas of cooperation, the minister called for the exchange of actionable intelligence through existing nodal agencies and greater coordination to combat terrorist financing and organised crime. Timely exchange of verified, actionable information on terrorists, their associates, criminal networks, financial channels and cross-border activities can strengthen collective security, he said.

On narcotics smuggling, Shah said no single country can stop it. "We must adopt a whole-of-region approach. The illegal proceeds from drugs provide financial strength to organised crime and are also used for terrorist financing. The diversion of precursor chemicals and transactions through the dark web make this challenge even more complex," he said.

The remarks described narcotics as more than just a law-and-order problem. They highlighted how drug money supports organised crime and terrorism financing in the Bay of Bengal region. Shah stressed the importance of working together to monitor supply chains, precursor chemicals, and illegal financial flows that often move across borders. The BIMSTEC comprises Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand. It aims to promote economic and technical cooperation among countries bordering the Bay of Bengal and in its neighbourhood.

While the grouping has traditionally focused on connectivity, trade and technical collaboration, the first dedicated meeting of home ministers signals a sharper focus on shared security threats that can undermine those broader goals.

Shah's emphasis on intelligence sharing, legal assistance and a regional stance against narcotics reflects an attempt to translate political statements into operational coordination. For India, the zero-tolerance line and the insistence that no member offer sanctuary continue a consistent diplomatic position. For the grouping as a whole, the meeting tests whether practical mechanisms can match shared geography and economic ambitions against threats that ignore borders.

India rejects China's objection to naming 28 Ladakh sites

ASHOKE RAJ New Delhi



India on Tuesday rejected China's opposition to the standardisation of names for 28 geographical locations and features in Ladakh, reiterating that the Union Territory is an integral part of the country.

The response followed objections from Beijing after India announced the official names last week. The locations include key areas along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), including Gogra and Hot Spring, which have been points of friction between Indian and Chinese forces.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said China's objections would not alter India's position on Ladakh's status.

"The UT of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India," Jaiswal said, adding that statements from the Chinese side could not change what India considers an established fact.

Referring to the Union Home Ministry's announcement dated October 2, Jaiswal said the statement clearly explained the purpose of the exercise. He noted that the 28 locations and geographical features had been assigned standard names for inclusion on the official Survey of India map, following consultations with the Ladakh administration and local stakeholders.

According to the spokesperson, the initiative is intended to ensure accurate identification of geographical features and improve public awareness of the region.

China, however, strongly criticised the move. Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning said Beijing did not recognise the Union Territory of Ladakh, describing its establishment as unilateral and illegal from China's perspective.

Mao also rejected India's decision to publish standardised names for the locations, calling the action illegal and void. She maintained that the western sector of the China-India boundary belonged to China.

The exchange highlights the continuing differences between the two countries over territorial claims in the western Himalayan region. Both sides have held multiple rounds of discussions to address border tensions, but disagreements over the boundary remain unresolved.

Rajnath, Czech Deputy PM discuss defence cooperation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


Defence Minister Rajnath Singh meets Czech Republic Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Industry and Trade Karel Havlicek in New Delhi PTI

India and the Czech Republic on Tuesday resolved to expand their bilateral defence cooperation, including exploring the possibility of co-development of military hardware as Defence Minister Rajnath Singh hosted Czech Deputy Prime Minister Karel Havlicek for wide-ranging talks. In January 2024, the two sides had identified defence among a handful of key sectors to further shore up cooperation. Havlicek is also the Czech Republic's Minister of Industry and Trade.

"Both leaders reviewed the entire spectrum of defence industrial cooperation between the two countries," the defence ministry said. "While the two sides welcomed the ongoing collaboration and successful establishment of various joint ventures, they agreed to further expand this cooperation, including under the aegis of India-Czech joint defence committee to promote 'Make-in-India' and 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat'," it said.

The ministry said the two leaders also discussed the ongoing issues of peace and security and acknowledged the need for greater cooperation to maintain regional stability. "They reiterated that the partnership between India and the Czech Republic is based on historical and cultural ties, and shared values of mutual trust and respect," it said in a statement.

Havlicek is on a four-day visit to India and is interacting with various ministries, trades and businesses bodies. He is scheduled to visit Bengaluru and Mumbai as well.

Former Punjab Police DIG Harcharan Singh Bhullar held

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

In a major crackdown on corruption within the Punjab Police, the Enforcement Directorate (ED)'s Chandigarh Zonal Office on October 9 arrested former Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Harcharan Singh Bhullar, who once headed the Ropar Range, under Section 19 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002.

The Special Court (PMLA) in Chandigarh has granted the agency eight days of custody to interrogate the senior officer in a case involving alleged disproportionate assets and the laundering of proceeds of crime.

This arrest is a significant step in an investigation that started after the CBI and the Anti-Corruption Branch in Chandigarh filed FIRs against Bhullar, an alleged middleman named Krishanu Sharada, and others under the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988. Investigators say the case involves a bribe-for-favour scheme. Bhullar is accused of asking Sharada for ₹8 lakh to gain an unfair advantage in a criminal case and accepting ₹5 lakh.

The money was reportedly meant to settle a case and protect a complainant from further police action, raising serious concerns about public trust in law enforcement. What has drawn particular attention is the scale of the assets. The large amount of assets found during searches has attracted significant attention.

CBI teams recovered ₹37 crore in cash and valuables worth another ₹2.32 crore from Bhullar's properties and related places. The items included cash, gold jewellery, luxury cars, bank deposits, and documents for commercial properties. Later, the Enforcement Directorate seized another ₹8.35 lakh in cash and froze bank accounts with about ₹1.42 crore.


Former Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Harcharan Singh Bhullar

Officials say these findings show clear signs of money laundering, with the money allegedly used to buy real estate, jewellery, and other assets for Bhullar and his family.8, describing him as a key broker who facilitated the alleged illicit transactions for the former DIG. His detention helped investigators piece together the network through which cash demands were reportedly routed and assets concealed.

ED sources say the probe is examining not only the specific bribe episode but also a broader pattern of wealth accumulation far beyond Bhullar's known sources of income during his service.

This case has led to new questions about how the Punjab Police oversee themselves, especially in handling criminal complaints and the use of intermediaries.

Bhullar has not yet made a public statement about the allegations. The large amount of unexplained cash and assets found has sparked debate about accountability among senior police officers. Legal experts point out that under the PMLA, once there is clear evidence of disproportionate wealth, the accused must explain the source of the assets.

The inquiry is still very much underway. The ED is still looking at further properties, examining financial links to Bhullar's family and associates, and checking whether the money in question was used for any other purchases or investments. Over the eight days of custody, they plan to go into great detail with Bhullar on the flow of funds, the role of the intermediaries and who the assets actually belong to.

Mehbooba Mufti, Mirwaiz Oppose Waqf Board plan for common sermon

MOHIT KANDHARI Jammu

The Jammu and Kashmir Waqf Board's plan to introduce common themes for Friday sermons (*khutbas*) across its affiliated mosques, shrines and Jamia Masjids has triggered sharp Opposition in the Union Territory.

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, PDP president Mehbooba Mufti, and the Muttahida Majlis-e-Ulema (MMU), headed by Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, have rejected the move, calling it unacceptable interference in religious affairs.

The controversy erupted after verbal instructions were given to Maulanas, Muftis, Imams and Khateebs during a recent meeting in Srinagar to deliver a common sermon.

An executive magistrate associated with the Board, Ishtiyaq Mohi-ud-Din, during the meeting reportedly said the Board had issued a directive nearly a month earlier to preachers to deliver a common khutba, or sermon. The Board has also sought suggestions on extending the arrangement to mosques outside its administration.

Board Chairperson Dr Syed Darakhshan Andrabi, a senior BJP leader, announced the constitution of a Core Committee of Muftis, Imams and Khateebs to identify and finalise common topics for Friday sermons and other religious occasions.

Themes were described as focusing on religious awareness, moral values, social harmony, unity, and matters of public and community interest in accordance with Islamic teachings, including issues such as drug abuse, youth problems, family concerns and social evils. Andrabi described the initiative as an effort to bring Imams across sects together to strengthen faith, reform society, uphold humanity and eradicate social evils.

Reacting strongly on Tuesday, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah posted on X: "This is an unacceptable attempt by the BJP to interfere in the religious affairs of Muslims and will not be accepted under any circumstances. The BJP appointed Chairperson must immediately halt this misplaced attempt to please her masters."

PDP president Mehbooba Mufti expressed strong concern, describing the proposal as interference in Muslim religious practices. She said Friday sermons are primarily shaped by the issues and circumstances confronting a particular region or locality, and imposing a uniform template disregards the diversity of local realities and the role of religious scholars. Mufti accused the BJP of using Jammu and Kashmir as a "laboratory" to test measures that could later be extended elsewhere, compared the push for uniformity to proposals for a Uniform Civil Code, and demanded that the administration of Waqf properties in J&K be transferred to the elected government. She further suggested that any coordination on sermons should be handled by the MMU headed by Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, and emphasised that faith cannot be dictated nor religious institutions subjected to arbitrary control.


PDP president Mehbooba Mufti

The Muttahida Majlis-e-Ulema, an amalgam of leading religious and socio-religious organisations headed by Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, issued a statement rejecting the move. It said: "Even the suggestion that a statutory body could determine or regulate what is to be preached from the Mimbar (pulpit) is ridiculous, and will never be accepted by the Muslims of Jammu and Kashmir." The body urged the Waqf Board to remain within its administrative responsibility of managing, maintaining and protecting Waqf properties rather than creating controversy.

Amid the backlash, Dr Syed Darakhshan Andrabi addressed a press conference in Srinagar on Tuesday and clarified that the Board has issued no order making uniform Friday sermons mandatory.

"There is no order. There is no order anywhere," she said. She stressed that neither she nor any Board official could dictate sermon subjects, asserting that independent religious scholars, preachers and sermon-givers would decide. "Even Darakhshan Andrabi cannot take any decision, nor can my officer take any decision. It is the decision of the independent scholars... that we should try to remove the vices in society."Andrabi said the proposed Core Committee would consist of religious scholars and that she would not be part of it. She highlighted the intent to address pressing social issues affecting youth, such as drugs, suicides, family concerns and mental trauma, and defended the initiative as a constructive effort. Responding to allegations of BJP interference, she said: "Where did BJP interfere? If I am the leader of BJP, I am proud."

Economic resilience key to national security: President

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


President Droupadi Murmu

President Droupadi Murmu on Tuesday said economic resilience is an integral part of the national security framework, and the Indian economy has time and again demonstrated its capabilities to absorb disruptions created by external factors.

Addressing faculty and course members of the 66th National Defence College (NDC) Course here, she said national security, today, extends beyond military capabilities and requires close cooperation between scientific institutions and the armed forces to translate innovation into practical solutions. Recent conflicts have highlighted the importance of cost-effective technologies that complement advanced defence systems and make the best use of available resources, the President said.

In this context, Government initiatives play an important role in strengthening the link between innovation and national security, she said, citing the Centre's Research, Development and Innovation Scheme to promote indigenous research and technological development.

It supports not only deep-tech startups but also the development of technologies critical to strategic requirements, economic security and Atmanirbharta, President Murmu asserted.

"Economic resilience is an integral part of the national security framework. Indian economy has demonstrated, time and again, its capabilities to absorb disruptions created by external factors. India has accomplished this without compromising the strategic freedom of action," she said. The President said many ancient Indian texts have elaborate descriptions about security response mechanisms and duties that a ruler must be aware of. The Valmiki Ramayan and Mahabharat present exhaustive narration of the many steps that a ruler is required to take to secure the state, she said.

Similarly, in the Shanti Parv of Mahabharat, Yudhishthir asks Bheeshma Pitamah how a ruler should govern and in his exhaustive reply, he elaborates several aspects of statecraft and the duties and responsibilities of an able ruler, President Murmu said.

"He talks about the strategies to protect the kingdom and subdue the enemies, including the management of a spying network. The guidance from Bheeshma goes beyond security. It emphasises security with societal cohesion. Under his theory of righteous rule, Bheeshma defines economic resources, diplomacy, defence and internal peace as its integral parts," she said. Addressing the faculty and course members, who had called on her at the Rashtrapati Bhavan, the President said many countries like India have recognised that the future landscape of national security would witness convergence of quantum technologies, biotechnologies and Artificial Intelligence (AI).

"Space-based capabilities have also become important for national security. The use of Artificial Intelligence in various domains of science, national security and economic activities is increasing by the day.

This technology is going to increasingly assist in strategic decision-making," she said. However, decision-making cannot be outsourced exclusively to this technology, and a balanced approach needs to be calibrated, President said.

12,400 new Durga Pujas get West Bengal Govt nod: CM

SAUGAR SENGUPTA Kolkata



With the new BJP Government giving all kinds of assurances of administrative cooperation to the Durga Puja organisers, Bengal has witnessed a massive increase of about 12,400 new Durga Pujas being organised in the State, taking the total tally to about 57,500 in 2026.

The announcement came from Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, who said that the new Pujas were being organised after they received State permission. Consequently, the state power department estimated that the peak power demand for the festival could go beyond 14,000 MW on October 13, on Tritiya or the third day of the Pujas. This is due to the increased installation of lights and pandals.

"Earlier, (during the Mamata Banerjee Government) you had to go to the High Court to organise Durga pujas. It was very sad to see that many Puja committees were not given permission... I do not think there is a single such case this time. Compared to the number of Durga pujas held in 2025, we have 12,400 more pujas this year," the Chief Minister said even as he went on inaugurating Durga Puja pandals post Mahalaya.

"Earlier no regard was given to customary rituals and the traditional Hindu astrological almanack when Pujas were inaugurated before the Mahalaya in Pitripaksha, which is inauspicious ... but this year round every small instruction of the Hindu directory would be maintained, and no inauguration will take place before Mahalaya," Adhikari said at a puja pandal.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

Editor's TAKE

Tame inflation before it turns into anger

The Government must act swiftly to protect purchasing power before the squeeze on livelihoods turns into wider economic and political discontent

One thing that affects every Indian more than anything else is the rising cost of everyday living. There may be many other issues, but none has a more immediate effect on citizens than inflation. It not only destabilises the budget of an ordinary citizen but also causes anger, which can quickly turn into outrage.

India's retail inflation has risen every month this year. From 2.74 per cent in January, the Consumer Price Index reached 5.54 per cent in September, the highest reading of 2026 and well above the RBI's 4 per cent target.

Food inflation leapt to 7.74 per cent, with onion prices more than doubling over the previous year. This is not a blip but a situation that can get out of hand if immediate action is not taken. The causes are not mysterious. The war in West Asia and the disruption around the Strait of Hormuz, the route for most of India's crude oil, have kept oil prices painfully high. Wholesale prices show what is coming down the pipeline: WPI inflation stood at 9.92 per cent in August, its fourth consecutive month above nine per cent, with fuel and power prices up nearly 23 per cent.

Diesel moves freight, while fertiliser shapes the next harvest. A deficient and uneven monsoon under El Niño conditions has added a food shock to an energy shock.

Salaried workers watch their real incomes shrink, small businesses face dearer inputs and weaker demand, and savers see returns eroded. Prolonged price pressures also breed anger.

Governments in the past have lost elections over onions in this country, and anger over food prices has fuelled street unrest elsewhere in the world. For a young population anxious about jobs, a ruinous grocery bill can turn quiet frustration into protest. Given the ongoing protests, it can add yet another dimension to them.

The response must be quick and layered. First, trim excise duties on petrol and diesel, with the Centre and states sharing the revenue sacrifice, so that fuel costs stop feeding into the prices of everything else. Second, release buffer stocks of onions, pulses and grain, ease import duties on edible oils and pulses, and allow states to act against hoarders.

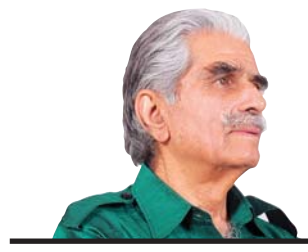
Third, protect the poorest through targeted transfers rather than blanket subsidies that inflate the deficit. Fourth, secure crude oil from diverse sources, keep strategic reserves topped up, and build up fertiliser stocks before rabi sowing.

The RBI, which held its policy rate at 5.25 per cent and projected retail inflation of 5 per cent for this financial year, must remain ready to act if price pressures persist. A Government is judged at the vegetable stall and the petrol pump long before the ballot box.

Controlling inflation is not charity. It is the first duty of economic stewardship. Delay compounds the cost, and public patience is finite.

Naga peace in peril

The decade-old Framework Agreement remains hostage to disagreements over sovereignty, a separate flag and constitution, and a deepening trust deficit. With NSCN (IM) threatening to revive insurgency, the Government must seize the latest initiative to negotiate a durable political settlement before the window for peace closes



ASHOK K MEHTA



The appointment last month of former Director, JIC, Ajit Lal, as interlocutor, along with additional political representation to kick-start the Naga peace process, stalled since 2021, has been welcomed by the Nagas. On October 26, 2025, the frail but spirited 92-year-old NSCN (IM) supremo Thuingaleng Muivah returned to Somdal village, his birthplace in Tangkhul Naga district, Manipur, and issued his sternest warning against the 'use of force' in the face of 'ultimatums from GoI' because of its difficulties 'in accepting their demand for a separate flag and constitution', adding, 'We will not surrender.' Muivah's most recent and dire threat to restart the insurgency, which PM Narendra Modi had intended to end with the big-bang Framework Agreement (FA) of August 3, 2015, one year after he came to power, came in his June 2026 interview with The Week magazine. Terminating the mother of all insurgencies was not going to be simple; it would entail 'sharing of sovereign power', which NSA Ajit Doval and principal interlocutor, IB Director RN Ravi, had assured they would be able to accomplish.

Ravi engaged Muivah and his team from 2014 to 2021 without achieving any breakthrough, even though he wore the additional hat of Governor of Nagaland from 2019 to 2021, when he was appointed Governor of Tamil Nadu. Strangely, the text of the FA was never made public, even as IB Special Secretary AK Mishra, on taking over from Ravi, informed Muivah that 'no record of GoI competencies submitted by Ravi was available'. In November 2024, Mishra retired and was downgraded from interlocutor to representative. He was also made an adviser to the North-East and diverted to Manipur. In despair, Muivah sought third-party intervention for the first time, though he and his people met Mishra in perfunctory, closed-door meetings between 2022 and October 2025 to ensure there was no 'breakdown' in talks.

The Nagas declared an insurgency in 1955, drawing Indian troops into the then Tuensang and Naga Hills, with PM Nehru's message to soldiers to 'win hearts of the people, not to frighten or terrify them'. The shooting down of an IAF Dakota in 1960 escalated the insurgency as I joined pacification operations with my battalion. The Indian Army fought one of the most intense insurgencies of all time, even after the Shillong Accord (1975) with the Naga National Council, which Muivah opposed, until the Ceasefire Agreement (1997), which, after 80 rounds of talks, culminated in the FA with NSCN (IM). Muivah points to the earlier Amsterdam Joint Communiqué with the Vajpayee Government in 2002, which recognised Naga sovereignty. In 2017, Ravi signed the Agreed Position with the seven Naga groups called the National Naga Peoples Group (NNPG), which Chairman of NSCN (IM) Q Tuccu called the 'Centre's deceitful agreement, created as a counterweight to the FA to divide the Nagas'. Recall that the FA was signed only with NSCN (IM) and not with NNPG, which was an afterthought. The GoI has said that both groups have to agree for the FA to be consummated, thereby changing the goalposts.

ON NAGA INDEPENDENCE DAY, AUGUST 14, 2026, MUIVAH REITERATED HIS QUEST FOR STRATEGIC AUTONOMY, HINTING AT GOI BETRAYAL AND THREATENING TO REVIVE THE INSURGENCY. THE NAGA ARMY PARADED SOME 2,500 ARMED CADRES CAMPED AT MOUNT HERMON NEAR DIMAPUR'S 3 CORPS HEADQUARTERS

People in Somdal said, 'Muivah must apologise for coming back empty-handed after 55 years.' A stalemate has existed since Ravi resigned as interlocutor. The FA's failure can be attributed to the absence of a full-time negotiator and the lack of a peace process focused on addressing political and administrative autonomy. Ravi was in a hurry to provide the Government with the FA, for which he allegedly ran roughshod over the NSCN (IM), creating distrust. He was unable, or more unwilling, to accommodate the constitutional issue of shared sovereignty, even as including Naga sovereignty in the Indian Constitution and accepting the Naga flag as a cultural symbol did not satisfy Muivah. He insisted on a Naga constitution and flag, which became impossible after the abrogation of Article 370, when the Nagas began to fear that even the constitutional safeguard of special status under Article 371A might be withdrawn. The Neiphiu Rio-led Nagaland Government is today opposition-less and aligned with the BJP. Rio has sought Home Minister Amit Shah's help to catalyse the FA. Muivah was deeply hurt when Ravi, as Governor, asked legislators to call NSCN (IM) 'lawless gangs' and accused Ravi of closing down talks at the behest of the RSS and NNPG. The NSCN (IM) says the Centre is using the Kuki and People's Defence Force against its camps in Myanmar's Sagaing region. The blame game goes on, even as 25 MPs urged Shah in February 2025 to disclose the FA's status in Parliament.

Twenty-five years of the CFA were celebrated in 2023, with Lt Gen Bedi (retd), who headed the Ceasefire Monitoring Group (CFMG), in attendance. NSCN (IM) sent long-range patrols to its camps in Myanmar and to one camp in Bangladesh. It has approached the International Court of Justice in The Hague and hired the services of legal luminary Michael Van Valt, who also represents the Free Tibet cause. Nearly 100 rounds of talks have failed to untangle the Naga issue. On the contrary, positions have hardened, and trust has become the biggest casualty. 3 Corps, which is in operational command of the North-East, is prepared for various inimical contingencies involving NSCN (IM).

On Naga Independence Day, August 14, 2026, Muivah reiterated his quest for strategic autonomy, hinting at GoI betrayal and threatening to revive the insurgency. The Naga Army paraded some 2,500 armed cadres camped at Mount Hermon near Dimapur's 3 Corps headquarters. Four to five smaller camps are located outside Nagaland and are also monitored by the CFMG. The Nagas are equipped with AK-47/56 rifles, M16 rifles, RPG-7s and even drones, and have caches in Myanmar. After Muivah, the line of succession is loaded with hard-line generals: V Atem, Anthony Shimiray, Q Tuccu and James Swu. The Naga Army's motivation and capability to fight an insurgency, though limited, pose a danger and could prove escalatory, given the irreversibly divisive situation in Manipur and the lawless, junta-controlled India-Myanmar border. Even after Operation Sindoor, J&K remains terrorism-primed, while Ladakh has been clumsily destabilised, alienating both Kashmiris and Ladakhis. With both the eastern and western frontiers on a razor's edge, the FA requires Doval's immediate attention, as waiting for Muivah 'to go' would not be a good idea.

The new political initiative, when operationalised, must include constitutional experts to accommodate the complex political Naga demands for shared sovereignty, a flag and a constitution to mutual satisfaction, with a compromise solution helmed by Shah himself. The military option is unthinkable, and time is running out.

The writer, a retired Major General, served as Commander, IPKF (South), Sri Lanka, and was a founder member of the Defence Planning Staff, now the Integrated Defence Staff

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Knowing When Enough Is Enough

Contentment is not having a great deal;
it is knowing when we have enough.

In Kalidasa's Raghuvamsa, a young scholar named Kautsa finished his studies and insisted that his teacher accept a fee. The teacher, irritated by his insistence, demanded fourteen crore gold coins, one crore for each branch of learning. Kautsa went to King Raghu, who had just given away all his wealth in a great sacrifice and was left eating from earthen vessels. Though his treasury was empty, Raghu considered it a greater shame to send a scholar away disappointed. He asked Kautsa to wait three days and prepared to obtain the gold from Kubera, the lord of wealth.

Before he could set out, gold coins are said to have rained down upon his treasury. Raghu offered all of it to Kautsa. Kautsa took only the fourteen crore he needed. Raghu insisted that he take more, but Kautsa refused, and the remainder was given away to the people.

Kautsa could have walked away rich,. He understood that a gift taken beyond need becomes a weight, and that gratitude is best shown through restraint. The scholar's refusal is the real wonder of the story. Tradition says this is why, on Vijayadashami, people exchange the leaves of the apta tree as a symbol of gold, a gesture that reminds us of sharing and sufficiency.

This Navaratri, name one thing you have been accumulating beyond your need, and share some of it with someone who has less.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



Workers prepare effigies of demon king Ravana ahead of the Dussehra festival in Patna. PHOTO: PTI

Repeating story of human birth – uncontrolled mind



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION



Imagine yourself riding in a chariot travelling along a road of peace, bliss and liberation (Kathopanishad 1.3.3-4). You have decided to give the reins (mind) to the chariot driver (intelligence). The mind is uncontrolled; that is, the reins are loose. The chariot driver is foolish and allows this to happen. The horses (senses) go crazy, attracted by the illusions of the material world (The Bhagavad-Gita 7.14). They leave the road and enter a wild forest full of ferocious animals (lust, greed and anger). All are devoured; the soul loses its material body and takes rebirth with the same senses, mind and intelligence (15.8) in a new body (chariot), and another journey begins.

What should have been done? The soul, a part of God (15.7), should have taken shelter in God — the Almighty- while travelling on the road full of dangers (8.15) all around it. God would then have become the chariot driver of life, as Lord Krishna became for Arjuna. The mind would have been controlled with the help of God — the Omniscient. The senses would have been forced to behave and not get distracted by the all-pervading 'Maya' (material attractions). And the soul would have continued along the road of peace (18.62), bliss (5.21) and liberation (18.62).

For this to happen, one must be very determined. Let us consider the degree of difficulty. What is the mind like? It is a faculty created by God for us souls to think, feel and will freely. The mind is part of our subtle body (7.4), along with intelligence and 'ahankar' (ego). It is fickle, forceful, strong and obstinate. It is extremely difficult to control (6.34), being subtle and, therefore, very powerful. It must be controlled; otherwise, it can cause a great deal of trouble, and it does.

Why is the mind so difficult to control? Because it has to be purified through spiritual practices, especially chanting (10.23). Ahankar will not let us take shelter in God, who alone can help us control the mind (7.14). Without God's help, our nature, controlled by the three modes, would not even allow us to want to control the mind.

What happens as a result of an uncontrolled mind? The mind favours the world over God, and thus the soul becomes bound to the world. Lust is already present in the mind, intelligence and body (3.40). One comes under the control of lust, greed and anger (16.21), and one becomes one's own enemy (6.6). Diseases are caused by imbalances in 'kapha' (cough), 'pitta' (acidity) and 'vata' (gas). Greed causes cough, anger causes acidity, and lust causes gas (Shri Ramcharitmanas, Uttar Kand, 120 Kha 15). Mental diseases take charge.

How, then, can the mind be controlled? Lord Krishna has given detailed instructions in the sixth chapter of the Bhagavad-Gita. Spiritual practices, especially meditation, really help, as does 'pranayam'. God provides spiritual intelligence to help us control the mind. Human life is then well utilised in the present, and one will be on the path to attaining liberation.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Jantar Mantar: A space for dissent

Apropos the news report 'Jantar Mantar: End of an era for Delhi's heart of dissent' (October 13), the de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a designated protest venue marks a setback for democratic dissent in India. For 33 years, this iconic site near the seat of governance served as a beacon for citizens, former soldiers, students and marginalised groups seeking accountability from those in power.

Relocating demonstrations to venues on the fringes of the capital, such as Burari Ground or CBD Ground, effectively dilutes the visibility and impact of peaceful public protests. Dissent loses its fundamental purpose when exiled far from the corridors of power where decisions are made. While maintaining public order and urban convenience are valid concerns, shifting legitimate agitations to distant outskirts risks undermining the fundamental rights to freedom of expression and peaceful assembly.

The Government must strike a thoughtful balance between maintaining civic order and preserving open spaces for public grievances. Depriving citizens of a central, accessible platform for peaceful protest weakens democratic governance. The authorities should reconsider this abrupt decision and ensure that a viable, centrally located space remains available for citizens to make their voices heard.

SANJAY CHOPRA | PUNJAB

Digital sovereignty at risk

This refers to the article 'Digital sovereign...', which makes interesting reading. Musk's statements on India's internal affairs must be viewed from various angles. Whether successive governments in independent India have functioned as captives of big business houses is for the people to decide. However, India's prevailing economic order limits its control over its own economy, allowing powerful economic forces to shape policies in their favour and potentially influence governments.

In the absence of meaningful economic control, monopolies emerge and increasingly fall under the influence of multinational and transnational corporations. Musk's statements signal potential dangers. If permitted to expand in India, his communication empire could gain considerable influence over communications and digital transactions. The Government's policies on foreign direct investment in sensitive sectors, including communications and defence, raise concerns about its ability to limit Musk's influence. Its own policies warrant scrutiny. Moreover, perceived concessions in bilateral trade with the US fuel fears of growing economic dependence. Musk could eventually challenge Ambani's dominance in India.

AG RAJMOHAN | ANDHRA PRADESH

Navratri: Faith, strength and triumph of good

Navratri is celebrated with devotion and enthusiasm across India, highlighting its religious, cultural and social significance.

Meaning 'nine nights', the festival honours Goddess Durga and her nine divine forms, collectively known as Navadurga. It symbolises the triumph of good over evil and righteousness over injustice. Devotees worship the Goddess, observe fasts, offer prayers and participate in cultural programmes, Garba and Dandiya dances. Each day represents a distinct virtue, from Shailaputri's strength and Brahmacharini's discipline to Chandraghanta's courage, Kushmanda's creative energy, Skandamata's compassion and Katyayani's determination. Kalaratri represents the destruction of darkness, Mahagauri symbolises purity, and Siddhidatri signifies wisdom and spiritual fulfilment. Navratri celebrates women's strength and dignity. Its true spirit lies in opposing violence, discrimination, corruption and other social evils.

Let us celebrate responsibly by reducing waste, avoiding excessive noise and maintaining cleanliness. May Navratri inspire us to overcome inner weaknesses and build a society founded on peace, justice, equality and mutual respect.

JUBEL D'CRUZ | MUMBAI

The Pioneer
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Geopolitics – need for a new communication strategy

As artificial intelligence and disinformation reshape the geopolitical landscape, the need for an integrated geostrategic communication architecture has become urgent. The challenge is to build a credible, coordinated and inclusive framework that aligns information, influence and public diplomacy without compromising truth or trust



CHAITANYA K PRASAD



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

The world today is in a state of constant and consistent flux, wherein disruption and distortion dominate proceedings, ideas and outreach simultaneously. Geopolitics today is witnessing an unprecedented 'tug of war': a war of ideas, resources, markets, communication tools and narrative-building. It is a battle of perception, survival and struggle across the borderless world, with the objective of attracting attention, reinforcing legitimacy and restoring credibility on a sustainable basis.

In such a scenario, the moot question remains: what should be the ideal 'Geopolitical Communication Architecture' that explains policies, actions and outreach with clarity and conviction? How does the architecture bring about 'Geopolitical Convergence' on narratives that dominate the power-play matrix globally? What should be the inputs, partnerships and scale of measurement that reinforce the story foundation of geopolitics and narrative-building strategy? The challenge in the remaining months of 2026 is to design a geostrategic communication structure that integrates perception, influence and information under one roof. The idea is to create an inclusive structure that brings all stakeholders together under one communication architecture.

When we talk about global power today, we rarely talk just about weapons or borders any more; we talk about stories. We talk about who controls the narrative. That is essentially what geostrategic communication is: shaping how a country is perceived in the global mind space and making that perception work in its favour.

Today, geostrategic communication has become a unique matrix, a blend of old-school credibility and new-age immediacy. On one side, you have in-depth think-tank reports, policy briefs and scholarly analyses; on the other, the rapid-fire social media blitzes that can alter global narratives in hours. Both coexist; both influence. Enter the era of podcasts, YouTube diplomacy, Twitter handles run by embassies, and viral reels of leaders meeting citizens. Communication is no longer just press releases and speeches; it is about aesthetics, relatability and digital fluency. Hence, do we need a strategic communication secretariat, a one-stop solution to all?

The reasons are manifold. Geopolitics today is no longer a mere messaging process. It serves several purposes and addresses diverse themes that shape perceptions in the long run. Hence, the narrative-building process in the geopolitical space requires multi-level interventions, tools and levels of mobilisation. The emerging perception is critical to understanding the role of geostrategic communication in the process.

While geostrategic communication is critical in defining outcomes and results, the structure to support it should be inclusive, innovative, visible and integrated. The structure should have the inherent capacity to understand real-time analytics, delve deeply into predictive analysis and study audience reactions. It should be able to comprehend the depth and dimensions of algorithmic tabulation, and the role of AI in facilitating the search for solutions, while avoiding technological overload and dependence. In view of the large-scale flow of content, any structure for geostrategic communication should be able to dissect and separate rhetoric and fakery from reality. The credibility quotient remains the key challenge in reducing the trust deficit in communication.

Any geostrategic communication structure needs to be adaptable to communication challenges and crises. There needs to be a clear understanding of the mandate and areas of coverage. While long-term objectives qualify as strategic goals and vision, there is an urgent need to address issues related to global monitoring, an aspect sometimes ignored due to the multiplicity of issues. Strategists ignore the impact of reputational risks and perceptions when viewed vis-à-vis social media tools, international media reportage and disinformation arising from negative perceptions. A critical component of the structure requires engagement at the people-to-people level, which, in diplomatic parlance, is called 'public diplomacy', utilising the dynamics of soft power, the diaspora and institutions. The structure should also incorporate the dynamics of crisis communication.

A new geostrategic communication framework cannot be an abstract idea; it needs a tangible structure. The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) should spearhead discussions on an international information governance framework, establishing a 'Threshold Agreement for Global Communication'. Such an initiative should include ethical standards for AI-generated content to ensure transparency and reduce algorithmic biases. It must also introduce a crisis communication protocol to prevent misinformation spirals during global emergencies. Additionally, a global fact-checking consortium should be established to unite journalists, researchers and policymakers in a collaborative effort to combat digital disinformation. Lastly, balanced digital sovereignty measures are essential to allow countries to maintain narrative control without suppressing free speech.

What we need is a renewed collaborative effort to establish a new 'Global Information Order', a platform established institutionally to bridge the gap in the medium-and-message equation. The 7Rs in communication, ie relevance, relatability, response, revival, reconnection, reconstruction and repositioning, need to be mainstreamed in the geopolitical setting. The new global order must work towards a framework that calibrates perceptions, builds relationships and drives action based on mutually agreeable communication tools. This mode should integrate rather than disconnect, create gaps or promote division, and establish a narrative that addresses opportunity, experiences and the vision of mutual coexistence. The changing geopolitical reality of 2026 highlights the need for adaptability in communication. Traditional media must evolve to remain relevant, embracing digital innovations and audience-centric approaches. Meanwhile, social media must grapple with issues of misinformation, polarisation and echo chambers, striving to become a platform that unites rather than divides. In this era, communication is no longer just about delivering a message; it is about shaping perceptions, building relationships and driving action.

One of the critical areas in which visible changes are being witnessed in 2026 is the geopolitical communication landscape. This year is positioned to redefine the very pathways of global communication, with a pivotal question arising: are we on the verge of a 360-degree transformation in communication delivery, content orientation, outreach mechanisms and the tools we deploy? Geopolitically, the communication ecosystem embraces a new language-a language of immediacy, focused messaging, results-driven delivery and the prioritisation of measurable outcomes to identify realistic patterns and global impacts. The era demands a communication framework that not only transcends borders but also bridges divides with precision, creativity and authenticity. In 2026, the phrase 'a picture is worth a thousand words' takes on greater resonance. Visual communication has become one of the most impactful ways to deliver messages. A single, well-composed image has the power to convey emotions, ideas and narratives that words may struggle to encapsulate. Building on this, the explosion of short-form videos and 30-second reels, for instance, has transformed the landscape further.

As the world awaits the impact of the changes taking place in the global order, the important question remains: does the communication and information landscape address the transformations occurring at multiple and multilayered levels? The changing communication landscape has an important role to play in the shifting paradigm across nations, regions and continents. It is undeniable that information overload, stress and the influx of data can cause a sort of information fatigue due to the constant flow from multiple sources. This phenomenon continues to make huge waves in the multipolar geopolitical world. In today's interconnected society, every issue is debated, analysed and perceived through tools of instant communication on a 24/7 basis. The rapid dissemination of information has led to narratives that evolve swiftly, influenced by shifting perceptions and biases. This constant flux presents new challenges, obstacles and limitations that restrict the role of communication in the geopolitical space. The immediacy of information exchange can exacerbate misunderstandings and escalate conflicts before there is time for measured responses.

What we need is a renewed collaborative effort to establish a new 'Global Information Order', a platform established institutionally to bridge the gap in the medium-and-message equation.

IN 2026, THE PHRASE 'A PICTURE IS WORTH A THOUSAND WORDS' TAKES ON GREATER RESONANCE. VISUAL COMMUNICATION HAS BECOME ONE OF THE MOST IMPACTFUL WAYS TO DELIVER MESSAGES. A SINGLE, WELL-COMPOSED IMAGE HAS THE POWER TO CONVEY EMOTIONS, IDEAS AND NARRATIVES THAT WORDS MAY STRUGGLE TO ENCAPSULATE. BUILDING ON THIS, THE EXPLOSION OF SHORT-FORM VIDEOS AND 30-SECOND REELS, FOR INSTANCE, HAS TRANSFORMED THE LANDSCAPE FURTHER

The writer is Former Civil Servant. Writes on strategic communication and cinema. Inputs provided by Zoya Ahmad and Vaishnavie Srinivasan

AI: What Indian Universities can learn from the West

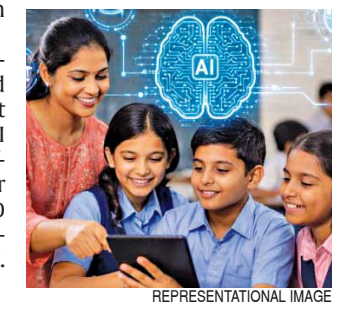


MD AFSHAR ALAM

Six years after the National Education Policy 2020 urged universities to break down the walls between subjects, artificial intelligence is becoming the tool for doing it. American and British universities moved earlier, and their experience offers lessons for Indian campuses still deciding how far and fast to go.

The Western experience

Ohio State University has set the most ambitious target. From the class of 2029, every graduate is expected to be fluent in AI and its responsible use within their own discipline. Provost Ravi V Bellamkonda says students will become "bilingual": fluent in their major and in applying AI within it. A course called "Unlocking Generative AI" is open to all majors, an AI skills seminar is compulsory, and at least six offices guide academic integrity. A history student uses AI for research, an agriculture student for crop data. Neither becomes a computer scientist. MIT built a new college instead. The Schwarzman College of Computing links computing with all five of MIT's schools, and its Common Ground programme helps departments design classes blending computing with other fields. A standing committee of 29 faculty members reviews proposals. Common Ground awards no major or minor of its own: its subjects sit inside existing degrees, so AI becomes part of a physics or economics degree rather than a side certificate. A separate initiative, SERC, embeds ethics in computing courses.



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

Oxford chose tools, training and governance together. It was the first UK university to give all students and staff free ChatGPT Edu access, after a year-long pilot with 750 staff members, and it created an AI Governance Group. Departments issue subject-specific guidance. California State University went for scale, rolling out ChatGPT Edu to more than 460,000 students and 63,000 staff members across 23 campuses, comparable to an Indian state university network.

The Indian experience

The push began with regulators. AICTE declared 2025 the Year of Artificial Intelligence, covering more than 14,000 colleges, and promised faculty workshops and certifications.

IIT Madras offers the closest parallel to Ohio State. Its "AI for All" courses on SWAYAM Plus, including AI in Physics, AI in Chemistry, AI in Accounting and Cricket Analytics with AI, need no prior AI or programming experience. In January, it launched them in Hindi, free to access, a step no Western example here has matched.

IIT Hyderabad echoes MIT's joint teaching: its 12-credit Minor in AI and Humanity has projects co-supervised by liberal arts, design and engineering faculty members. IIT Mandi offers its 24-credit AI minor to other institutions. Oxford's route has arrived too. In February, OpenAI announced ChatGPT Edu partnerships with IIT Delhi, IIM Ahmedabad, AIIMS New Delhi, Manipal, UPES and Pearl Academy, covering more than 100,000 people. Beyond the elite, the Central University of Haryana will introduce AI courses across all programmes from 2026-27, nearing Ohio State's model.

Where the approaches differ

Mandate: Ohio State makes AI fluency a graduation outcome. Most Indian institutions offer a minor, elective or online course, so many arts, social science and language graduates will leave without it.

Course design: At MIT, computing and subject faculty members build courses together. In most Indian universities, computer science departments still write them. A chemistry teacher untrained in AI cannot shape "AI in Chemistry", and a computer scientist alone will miss what chemists need.

Tools and governance: Oxford and Cal State prioritised secure tool access, and Oxford and Ohio State built oversight. In India, access remains confined to well-funded institutions. Most state university students use free consumer tools with weaker data privacy, and many universities have no AI policy, so rules vary from teacher to teacher.

Language: Here, India leads. Free Hindi courses address a problem Western universities rarely face and reach colleges that will never sign enterprise agreements.

Scale and teachers: India's state systems are far larger than Cal State's, so a national or state-level agreement, perhaps through the IndiaAI Mission, would serve equity better than institution-by-institution deals. And every Western success began with faculty members; short certification programmes do not change how a teacher designs assignments or examinations.

What implementation requires

Educationists point to six steps:

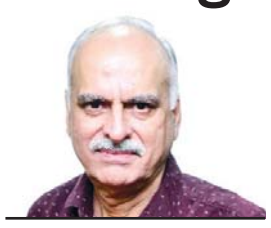
1. Define AI competence as a programme outcome for every degree, in each discipline's language.
2. Create joint teaching committees on the Common Ground model, with credit flowing through the Academic Bank of Credits.
3. Write an AI policy on assessment, plagiarism, data privacy and research, with room for subject-specific rules.
4. Rethink examinations: take-home essays are easy to generate, while viva voce, in-class writing and project defences test learning.
5. Negotiate shared access to secure AI platforms so district-college students get the protection IIT students have.
6. Expand content in Urdu, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Marathi and other languages, and teach ethics inside each subject, where caste, gender and regional bias carry real weight.

Conclusion

The Western universities succeeded through institutional decisions, not better technology: Ohio State set a clear rule, MIT built the habit of joint work, Oxford prepared teachers and governance first, and Cal State used its size to win fair terms. Each is within reach of Indian universities. India has advantages the West lacks: NEP 2020's credit framework, SWAYAM as a national channel, and proof that subject-linked AI teaching can work free in an Indian language. The gap lies in the middle layer: the state and central universities that teach most Indian students and still treat AI as optional. The next two academic years will decide whether multidisciplinary learning becomes real for them. If academic councils make AI competence part of every degree, train teachers before students and write clear rules, success will look like a botany graduate in Bihar or a law graduate in Kerala who can use AI confidently in her field and judge when it is wrong.

The writer is the former Vice-Chancellor of Jamia Hamdard

Congress must end its inertia to lead the INDIA bloc in these testing times



ANIL ANAND



There is good and bad news for the Congress, which is struggling hard to shed inertia and indecisiveness and emerge from its own cobweb. The more it tries, though through feeble attempts, the more it remains the same, without realising the need to become battle-ready for the coming electoral contests. While circumstances are fast changing in favour of the Grand Old Party (GOP), its leadership seems mostly unaware of the role that the party, as the premier opposition party, is expected to play at such a crucial juncture.

As the crescendo has gathered stormy proportions over the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI) — a front-ranking constitutional body responsible for conducting free and fair elections — in a totally opaque and centralised manner, the INDIA combine of opposition parties finally coming together is a significant development. It is another matter that they shared the table after a couple of electoral setbacks and regular sniping at each other. However, circumstances have perhaps left them with no option but to come together and resolve to fight back to protect the "sanctity of the vote".

If the INDIA bloc meeting has thrown a direct challenge to the ECI and the Narendra Modi-Amit Shah combine by declaring a joint programme of nationwide protests against the usurpation of the electoral process, it has come as a happy augury for the Congress, which, until the other day, was at the receiving end of its alliance partners. Instead of making the Narendra Modi-led dispensation its main target, the allies had preferred to target the Congress, and more so Rahul Gandhi.

From all available accounts and the optics of it, the September 30, 2026, INDIA bloc meeting has firmly established the Congress as its leader. Not only was the most mercurial and unpredictable ally-leader and Trinamool Congress chief, Mamata Banerjee, seen going overboard to exhibit her bonhomie towards the Congress leadership led by Sonia Gandhi and, surprisingly, even Rahul Gandhi, but more or less all the 20-odd alliance partners attending the meeting ceded total space to the GOP in deference to its status as the only national party with a pan-India presence among the alliance ranks. This feeling was altogether missing during the last three years of its existence.

The media reports undoubtedly suggest that the alliance's high-profile meeting successfully unified the opposition around a roadmap, surprisingly crafted by the Indian National Congress. This, in turn, has placed the party on a firm political footing. Unimaginable until the political events shaped by the goings-on in the corridors of Nirvachan Sadan, the INDIA combine adopted the core resolutions that had earlier been passed by the Congress Working Committee (CWC).

The narrative and agenda of the combined meeting heavily mirrored the strategy crafted by the Congress just a day earlier during its CWC meeting. This position solidified the Congress's leading role within the alliance through several key developments.

However, the second development, emerging from the same AICC corridors where the CWC meeting was held to set the course for the INDIA bloc deliberations, should worry the Congress's top leadership. It concerns poll-bound Punjab, where the Congress, with good chances of returning to power after a decade, has been on a suicidal mission. The high command's decision to replace Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) chief Amarinder Singh Warring, after initial reluctance and dilly-dallying, is more baffling than creditworthy. It came after wasting precious time trying to control factionalism and humiliating senior leaders tasked with bringing the warring factions together. The then AICC in-charge of Punjab and former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel lost both face and his job. This was through no fault of his, as he ostensibly followed the high command's directions (read Rahul Gandhi) to protect Warring at all costs, despite growing resentment against him within the PCC. Even more importantly, further embarrassment was in store when the high command chose to sweep under the carpet the findings of the committee headed by AICC treasurer Ajay Maken, who had been entrusted with the task of gauging the mood of a cross-section of the state leadership. The committee, it is believed, found an overwhelming mood in favour of a change in the PCC leadership.

The Punjab episode should be an eye-opener for the GOP's top leadership and force it into the introspection that is sorely needed to set its house in order at a time when the entire opposition has reposed confidence in Rahul Gandhi's leadership. Effecting a change on the basis of the Maken committee's findings would not only have protected the high command from embarrassment but also saved the party from negative publicity for unnecessarily dragging out the issue before subsequently changing the state leadership.

A situation similar to Punjab's prevails in several other states and Union Territories, particularly Jammu and Kashmir. Quick decisions are needed to strengthen the organisation. The top leadership must evaluate its conduct in Punjab and take corrective steps elsewhere, including within the AICC's organisational structure.

A strong, battle-hardened organisation will help the Congress establish its leadership role in the INDIA combine. The shift in the allies' mood on September 30, 2026, should be capitalised on to strengthen Rahul Gandhi's leadership. Building on the alliance's agitation roadmap and the CWC resolution, the Congress must strengthen itself internally, no matter what the cost.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge took centre stage to officially announce the bloc's six-point joint protest strategy. However, it seemed that the veteran of many political battles, Kharge, had read the mood of the INDIA conglomerate leaders gathered at Delhi's Constitutional Club. Perhaps he thought it was the right moment to press Rahul Gandhi to address the press conference, with the purpose of keeping him centre-stage.

In declaring the six-point protest strategy, Kharge left no one in doubt that Rahul Gandhi would be leading from the front. The two-pronged fight for him and Rahul Gandhi now is to steer the INDIA bloc effectively and, at the same time, prevent Punjab-like situations from arising through quick and stern decision-making.

The bloc's six-point joint protest strategy:

1. October 2-8: District-level "Save Democracy" marches across the country.
2. October 6: A coordinated march by all Opposition MPs to the Election Commission headquarters.
3. Mid-October: Seeking official intervention from the President of India.
4. November 1: A mega joint rally in New Delhi.

The challenge for the Congress, as the leader of the opposition grouping, is enormous. But the opportunity is golden: to shed inertia and set itself on course for internal and external reforms.

The writer is a media expert and policy analyst

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Manoj Kumar Sharma's appointment as Chief Justice reshapes Constitution Bench tradition



KIRAN PAUDEL

Currently, no specific or objective criteria have been defined for selecting judges for the Constitutional Bench. As a result, the sole basis for selection has now become the "will or discretion of the Chief Justice." This issue has sparked a serious debate both inside and outside the judiciary.

Has this situation led to a confrontation among the judges themselves?

Last Monday (28th september), a Emergency Full Court meeting was held at the Supreme Court. While other agendas were discussed, one major agenda item was the formation of the Constitutional Bench. Asking the Chief Justice about the process of bench formation, the judges questioned: Why is there no participation of senior judges in the Constitutional Bench?

According to a judge who attended the meeting, the Chief Justice remained silent on this issue.

Ever since he was appointed Chief Justice in the May 2026 , the formation of the Constitutional Bench has been operating at Chief Justice Sharma's discretion. The bench has consistently comprised judges handpicked by Chief Justice Sharma. However, many judges are dissatisfied with this approach. They argue that clear criteria must be established for forming the bench.

The Nepal Bar Association has also been criticizing the Chief Justice's style. The Bar has repeatedly drawn attention to the issue, urging that "provisions be made immediately to form the Constitutional Bench based on seniority or the lottery system."

Before Sharma became Chief Justice, the bench used to be formed on the basis of seniority.

What is the dispute over Bench formation?

Article 137 of the Constitution of Nepal provides for the constitution of a Constitutional Bench. It envisages that constitutional matters should be resolved through this bench. Clause 1 of the same article specifies that there shall be one Constitutional Bench in the Supreme Court. It states that such a bench shall consist of the Chief Justice and four other judges designated by the Chief Justice on the recommendation of the Judicial Council.

The judicial system adopted by Nepal is considered part of the Common Law system. In systems following the Common Law tradition, the authority to form a Constitutional Bench and select judges rests with the Chief Justice Dr Adish C Aggarwala, President of the International Council of Jurists, notes the same:

"The formation of a Constitutional Bench and the nomination of judges are the prerogative of the Chief Justice, as there are no specific constitutional or procedural guidelines on judicial selection. In India, the Chief Justice nominates judges to Constitutional Benches, regardless of their seniority. This flexibility allows senior judges to handle other important cases and ensures effective judicial functioning. Constitutional cases require extensive hearings due to their significance and are closely observed nationally and internationally."

Dr Aggarwala, who is also the President of the All India Bar Association, explains that since the Chief Justice is constitutionally vested with this



authority, the Bar Association may express a differing opinion on the Chief Justice's action, but it cannot dictate it:

"The Chief Justice, as the master of the roster, has the authority to allocate cases and select judges based on their experience, expertise and capabilities, rather than seniority alone. The Bar Association, as an equal partner in the administration of justice, has the right to raise concerns and request the inclusion of senior judges but cannot dictate the Chief Justice's selection. The Chief Justice should consider such requests while balancing the workload and importance of other pending cases. Including all senior judges in a Constitutional Bench should not be a mandatory practice but should depend on judicial requirements and administrative feasibility."

At first glance, deciding which judges serve on the Constitutional Bench appears to be the "constitutional prerogative of the Chief Justice." Why then is the Bar opposing it? The Bar maintains that objective criteria are essential. Bijay Prasad Mishra, President of the Nepal Bar Association, levels a serious charge, stating that the absence of criteria for forming the Constitutional Bench has turned the judiciary into a "superstore":

"The lottery system is the practice best suited to Nepal's soil. We brought in the lottery system after protesting for 109 days against the buying and selling of justice within the judiciary. A tradition of appointing senior judges to the Constitutional Bench was also established. To maintain judicial tradition and impartiality, clear criteria are indispensable."

The question is not merely about constitutional authority; it is also tied to judicial tradition and the reasons behind adopting that tradition. Reminding of past instances where the Chief Justice's discretion led to the bargaining of justice, Bar President Mishra argues for the necessity of standards: "When authority was vested solely in the Chief Justice, we witnessed maneuvering and claims of settling cases for favors. We also saw interference from various power centers. If the previous state of affairs is being brought back, the Bar will take a stance. This issue was raised in the Full Court itself; the court has become like a superstore."

However, former Supreme Court Justice Balaram KC believes there is no reason for the Bar to protest.

Justice KC says:

"The present Chief Justice appears to be exercising his constitutional authority. Just because a past Chief Justice misused certain powers does not mean everyone will do so. The Chief Justice can exercise the rights written in the Constitution judiciously."

AFTER-EFFECTS OF ARTICLE 137

'Why Today?' Justice Phuyal Questions CJ Sharma Over Constitutional Bench Formation

Before the Constitutional Bench was scheduled to sit, while the judges had gathered in the joint chamber, Justice Hari Phuyal questioned Chief Justice Manoj Kumar Sharma about why he had not been included in the benches so far and why he had been included today.

"There must be a reason why I was not included yesterday or the day before, and why I have been included today. I have no issue with not being included previously. But now, let us discuss what lies behind this," a judge who was present quoted Justice Phuyal as saying.

In the past, Chief Justice Sharma had constituted Constitutional Benches without Justice Phuyal. However, a Supreme Court justice said that Justice Phuyal questioned the decision after he was suddenly included in the bench.

Historical context

Disputes regarding the formation of the Constitutional Bench in Nepal's judiciary are not new. When then-Prime Minister KP Sharma Oli dissolved Parliament for the first time, then-Chief Justice Cholendra Shumsher Rana prepared to handpick four judges himself instead of appointing the bench based on seniority while the case was pending before the Constitutional Bench.

He backed down following widespread opposition. Since then, although the lottery system was not applied to the Constitutional Bench, a practice was established to form the bench including judges based on seniority. Former Chief Justice Prakash Man Singh Raut also bypassed seniority to place a junior judge on the Constitutional Bench in one case, but Raut backed down after fierce opposition from the Bar.

Due to the controversy, the Constitutional Bench could not even be formed for some time after that.Overall, the dispute over the formation of the Constitutional Bench is a conflict between the Chief Justice's constitutional authority as "master of the roster," past abuses of this authority, the tendency of "pick and choose," and questions surrounding judicial impartiality.

The writer is a judicial, foreign, and security affairs lead and sub-editor at Kantipur Television in Nepal, covering constitutional affairs, governance and national security

Order Order

SC impleads ILBS in free treatment compliance case

RANJIT KUMAR SINHA ■ New Delhi

In a significant development concerning institutional accountability and accessible healthcare, the Supreme Court has formally impleaded the Institute of Liver and Biliary Sciences (ILBS), Vasant Kunj, as a party respondent in ongoing proceedings. The petition accuses ILBS of systemic non-compliance with the apex court's landmark judgment which mandates that hospitals allotted land at concessional rates must fulfill obligatory quotas of providing free medical treatment and healthcare access to economically weaker sections of society. A bench comprising Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar recently issued formal notice returnable on November 4, 2026, directing that "Notice of this application be issued only to the newly impleaded respondent(s)/ILBS, returnable on 4 novermer 2026".

The outcome of this legal battle could establish a vital precedent for enforcing mandatory charitable quotas in elite, publicly funded medical institutions across the Capital. The legal proceedings stem from a miscellaneous application filed by Rahul Raj, a citizen who lost his mother during her treatment at the hospital.

The petition brought to light a glaring contradiction between the institute's establishment on Government land using public funds and its current operations. Built using approximately `800 crores from the public exchequer, ILBS was ostensibly established to serve charitable and patient-care objectives. However, the plea alleges that the institute functions on a commercial "Revenue Sharing Scheme," subverting its foundational public service mandate into a profit-generating enterprise. The applicant has flagged severe institutional malpractices encountered during his mother's care. These include the alleged denial of CGHS cashless facilities despite holding a valid card, mandatory registration under a single senior doctor without personal examination, unauthorized transfer of biological samples to private entities for research without consent, and commercially driven ICU escalations followed by exorbitant billing.

Furthermore, the petition draws heavily from Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) constitutional audits from 2018 and 2023, which flagged serious financial irregularities, including the diversion of ₹60 crores into an unapproved corpus fund, unadjusted advances exceeding ₹36 crores, non-serviceable equipment worth `9.68 crores, and a governance collapse marked by a three-year hiatus in Finance Committee meetings.

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10.	DL0510610003201/Mr. AMARDEEP KUMAR/MEENAKSHI M/Gurgaon Branch	Khasra 20/23/1, Front Side Roof Rights, Plot- 2,Floor No: 3rd, T-Extn. Part III, Matiala, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, 110059	29-06-2026	₹ 1,255,905	12-10-2026
11.	UP0210610003692/ RADHE SHYAM SINGH/Noida	GUT NO: KHASRA NO 322 TO 330,BUILDING NAME: ROYAL AVENUE APARTMENT,HOUSE NO: FLAT NO.03,FLOOR NO: UPPER GR,PLOT NO: PVT PLOT NO.1,STREET NAME: BLOCK-A,SECTOR WARD NO: BLOCKA, LAND MARK: SUNDER FARM HOUSE,VILLAGE: SARFABAD,LOCATION: NOIDA, TALUKA: DADRI,STATE: UTTAR PRADESH,PIN CODE: 201301	10-11-2025	₹ 2,139,183	10-10-2026
12.	UP0510610003047/Mr. DHARMENDRA KUMAR SHARMA/NITU SHARMA/Gurgaon Branch	Khasra No 107, Sai Residency, Flat No 301, Third Floor, Plot No: 3, Shahberi, Dadri,Gautam Budha Nagar Uttar Pradesh, 201301	29-06-2026	₹ 1,204,991	09-10-2026
13.	UP0510610001686/Mr. DIPANKAR SAIKIA/RITA DEORI/Gurgaon Branch	Gaur City 1, D 1003,Floor No: 10th,Plot No: Gh 01, Lotus 1, Alpha Greater Noida,Gautam Budha Nagar Uttar Pradesh,Pin Code: 201310	29-06-2026	₹ 3,966,017	09-10-2026
14.	DL0510610005465/Mr. ANIL A/REENA ROY/Gurgaon Branch	Khasra No-27/11/3, Entire 3rd Floor With Roof Rights Plot No: Rz-1679 And Old No-25, Rani Bagh, Shakur Pur, Delhi110034	29-06-2026	₹ 2,436,116	12-10-2026
15.	HR0510610003494/Mr. SAJJAN KUMAR//Gurgaon Branch	Khata No 4 ,M No 28, Kila N10, Sahjawas, Sohna,Gurgaon, Haryana, 122103	29-06-2026	₹ 1,392,240	12-10-2026
16.	DL0510610003119/Mr. PANKAJ SALALAIN/ANITA A/Gurgaon Branch	Khasra no. 10/32, FRONT LEFT SIDE, THIRD floor,Plot No: C-14, MANSARAM PARK, Uttam Nagar, Delhi,110059	29-06-2026	₹ 2,461,492	12-10-2026
17.	DL0510610005272/Mr. HARBEER SINGH//Gurgaon Branch	Kh No-18/18.19and23, Entire 3rd Floor With Roof Right, Plot No: Rz-17a, T-Block Sec-2,Street No: 05, Matiala, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059	29-06-2026	₹ 1,991,831	12h-10-2026
18.	UP0510610002894 / PRAKASH CHAND PANDEY / MEENA PANDEY / GURGAON BRANCH	KH NO-191,NAND RESIDENCY, HOUSE NO: 205,FIRST FLOOR ,PLOT NO: 1, NAND VATIKA PH-3, BLOCK A, GIRGHARPUR SUNARSI, DADRI, UTTAR PRADESH- 203207	18-02-2026	₹ 963,012	09-10-2026
19.	DL0610600000972/ MR. MANISH KUMAR JHA & MRS. LATA JHA /MEERUT BRANCH.	KHASRA NO-679/2 HOUSE NO-C-3 FLOOR NO-2nd PLOTNO-679/2-A BLOCK-A SATYA SAI NIKETAN PUBLIC VILLAGE DEVLI DEOLI HAUZ KHAS NEW DELHI-110062.	05-05-2025	₹ 1,623,540	09-10-2026
20.	DL0111300107067/ RAKESH RAM / SEEMA KUMARI / DELHI BRANCH	" FLAT NO-855 FIRST FLOOR, DDA LIG FLAT POCKET-A LOKNAYAKPURAM, DELHI, DELHI SUDHANSHUJI MAHARAJ ASHRAM Land Mark: SUDHANSHUJI MAHARAJ ASHRAM, Police Station: LOKNAYAKPURAM, Pin Code: 110041,	17-06-2026	₹ 785,183	08-10-2026
21.	DL0110610003067 / SUNIL KUMAR JHA / VISHAKHA SINGH/ DELHI BRANCH	Flat No.TF-1 Third Floor with roof/terrace right towards front side of built-up property bearing Plot No.3-A and 3-B, admeasuring 50 sq. yds. i.e. 41.81 sq. mtr., out of Khasra No.105/17/2, situated in the revenue estate of Village Palam, Delhi State Delhi, area abadi known as colony Rajapuri, Block-D-1, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059	17-06-2026	₹ 1,450,233	08-10-2026
22.	DL0111510008861/ MANOJ KUMAR / DELHI BRANCH	First Floor Without Roof Right Out Of Built Up Property No. RZF1/136 A, Area Measuring 62.2158 Sq. Mtr. (78 Sq. Yds.), Out Of Khasra No. 88/3, Situated In The Revenue Estate Of Village Palam, Delhi State Delhi Colony Known As Mahavir Enclave, New Delhi-110045,	17-06-2026	₹ 4,397,853	08-10-2026
23.	DL0111300103277 / HARI SINGH / DELHI BRANCH	H.No. MCF-33, Sanjay Colony A-Block, Sec.22, Faridabad H.R-121007	27-06-2026	₹ 403,475	08-10-2026
24.	UP0110610004662 / KANHAIYA KUMAR SINHA / SHAIL KUMARI SINHA / DELHI BRANCH	Flat No. G-002 (Ground Floor) (without roof rights) has a covered area of 585 sq. ft. (54.34 sq. meters) and is constructed on freehold residential Plot Nos. 94, 95, and 96 (comprising Khasra No. 139) in the colony known as Sai Garden-2 / APS Royal Homes, Shahberi, Pargana and Tehsil Dadri, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P.-201009	17-06-2026	₹ 1,214,653	08-10-2026
25.	DL0110610007572 / SHOBHIT KUMAR GURUDEV / RACHNA / DELHI BRANCH	Front Side First Floor Portion Bearing Pvt. No. B-2 Without Its Roof/Terrace Rights, Area Measuring 80 Square Yards Or Say 66.88 Square Meters, Lower Ground Floor Portion (For One Small Car Only), A Part Of Aforesaid Built-Up Property Comprising In Khasra No.784/3min., Situated In The Extended Lal Dora Abadi Of Village Burari, Delhi-110084	27-06-2026	₹ 2,075,918	08-10-2026
26.	DL0110610005555/ PRIYANKA BISHT / MOHIT SHUKLA / DELHI BRANCH	GUT No: KHASRA NO 488/1, FLAT 101,Floor No: FIRST,Plot No: A-1/3,Street Name: NAN,Sector Ward No: WARD NO 201,Land Mark: SAINI ATTA CHAKKI TEACHE,Village: MOLARBAND,Location: Badarpur (South Delhi),Taluka: DELHI,State: Delhi,Pin Code: 110044	27-06-2026	₹ 1,877,531	08-10-2026
27.	DL0110610005699 / SHALABH SAINI / BALBIR KAUR / DELHI BRANCH	Property bearing No. A-1/3, total measuring 282 sq. yds., (235.780 sq. mtrs.), part of Khasra No. 488/1, situated in the area of lal dora in Village Molarband, Badarpur, New Delhi110044,	27-06-2026	₹ 1,681,673	08-10-2026
28.	HR0111510007452 / PREM SINGH / KAMLESH / DELHI BRANCH	GUT No: SHREE HOMES-PHASE II,Building Name: SHREE HOMES BY SARVOME,House No: FLAT NO. 1003,Floor No: 10TH FLR,Plot No: TOWER - A,Street Name: SECTOR - 45,Street No: N/A,Sector Ward No: SECTOR - 45,Land Mark: MAHARAJPUR METRO STN.,Village: MEWLA MAHARAJPUR,Location: Amarnagar (Faridabad),Taluka: FARIDABAD,State: Haryana,Pin Code: 121003	17-06-2026	₹ 698,261	08-10-2026
29.	UP0210610003577/SARJAN SINGH/Noida	GUT NO: KHASRA NO. 46,BUILDING NAME: SBI-I,HOUSE NO: FLAT NO. B-301,FLOOR NO: THIRD,PLOT NO: PLOT ON KHATA NO. 6,STREET NAME: BLOCK-B,SECTOR WARD NO: DADRI,LAND MARK: MAHAGUN MY WOODS PROJECT,VILLAGE: VILL SHAHBERI,LOCATION: NOIDA,TALUKA: G B NAGAR,STATE: UTTAR PRADESH,PIN CODE: 201301,	27-06-2026	₹ 829,771	10-10-2026
30.	DL0710600001366/RITESH KUMAR/ GREATER NOIDA BRANCH	DDA JANTA FLAT, FLAT NO: 181-C, SECOND FLOOR, SECTOR/WARD NO: SHAHPUR JAT VILLAGE: SHAHPUR JAT, TALUKA: HAUZ KHASH, STATE: DELHI: 110049.	14-07-2026	₹ 1,252,838	13-10-2026

Further, to this notice , borrower are hereby called upon in compliance of Sub-Rule (6) of Rule 8 of Security interest (enforcement) Rule, 2002, NOTICE is also hereby given to the borrowers above named that the GICHFL shall now proceed to sell the above-referred Secured Assets by adopting any of the methods provided under SARFAESI Act 2002 and rules thereunder after 30 days from the date of this notice.

The BORROWERS and the PUBLIC IN GENERAL is hereby cautioned not to deal with the above referred Properties/Secured Assets or any part thereof and any dealing with the said Properties/Secured Assets shall be subject to charge of GICHFL for the amount mentioned hereinabove against Properties/Secured Assets which is payable with the further interest thereon until payment in full.

This notice is being published under Rule 8 (2) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and also pasted at conspicuous place of the respective properties.

Date: 14.10.2026
Place: Pitampura, Gurgaon, Meerut, Delhi, Noida, Greater Noida

For GIC Housing Finance Ltd.
Sd/- Authorised Officer

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

RECPDCL hands over two SPVs of Inter State Transmission projects to bidders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



REC Power Development and Consultancy Limited (RECPDCL), a wholly owned subsidiary of REC Limited, a Maharatna CPSU under the Ministry of Power, handed over two project-specific Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs), namely Jam Khambhaliya Jamnagar Power Transmission Limited and Lakadia II Power Transmission Limited, to the respective successful bidders on 12th October 2026.

The projects were awarded through the Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) route, with RECPDCL as the Bid Process Coordinator, for development of the projects on a Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis. The SPVs were formally handed over by T S C Bosh, Director (Projects), REC Limited, in presence of other officials from RECPDCL and the respective developers.

Lakadia II Power Transmission Limited — handed over to M/s Power Grid Corporation of India Limited

M/s Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (PGCIL) emerged as the successful bidder for the inter-state transmission project titled "Transmission system for Integration of Power from RE Projects in Lakadia REZ in Gujarat-Phase II (7500MW)".

The SPV was handed over to Arup Samanta, General Manager (CS), PGCIL, in the presence of Amit Bhargav, ED (TBCB), PGCIL, and other senior officials from PGCIL and RECPDCL.

The transmission project broadly envisages establishment of 765/400 kV, 6x1500 MVA & 10x500 MVA, 400/220 kV Lakadia-II substation (Near Chitrod) with 2 Nos. of Synchronous Condensers at the Lakadia II substation; 765 kV D/c Lines from Lakadia II to Halvad (141 km), Lakadia II to Ahmedabad (197 km) and Lakadia II to Vataman (261 km) along with other associated works. The project is scheduled for implementation within 36 months.

Jam Khambhaliya Jamnagar Power Transmission Limited — handed over to M/s Ceigall India Limited

M/s Ceigall India Limited emerged as the successful bidder for the inter-state transmission project titled "Common Transmission System for evacuation of power from Lakadia (Phase-II: 7.5GW), Jam Khambhaliya (Phase-II: 5.5GW) and Jamnagar (Phase-I: 1GW) - Part-B".

The SPV was handed over to Ayyalusamy Saravanan, CEO, Ceigall India Limited, in the presence of other senior officials from Ceigall India Limited and RECPDCL.

The transmission project broadly envisages establishment of 765/400 kV, 3x1500 MVA & 400/220 kV, 3x500 MVA Nasik substation, 765 kV D/c Line from Nasik to South Olpad (266 km), 400 kV D/c line from Nasik to Pimpalgaon (MSETCL) (40 km) along with associated works. The project is scheduled for implementation within 36 months.

Northern Railway organises safety and quality improvement camps for OHE upgradation works

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



To strengthen the safety culture, quality consciousness, and adherence to prescribed standards in ongoing infrastructure development, Northern Railway organised a comprehensive series of Safety & Quality Seminar-cum-Interaction Sessions for 2×25 KV Overhead Equipment (OHE) upgradation works, Northern Railway said in a press release.

The camps were successfully conducted across four major locations during October 2026: Jalandhar (01.10.2026), Ambala (05.10.2026), Moradabad (09.10.2026), and Lucknow (12.10.2026). The initiative brought together 550 participants, included 42 officers, 169 divisional TRD staff, 112 project unit staff (from the Ambala & Lucknow Electrification Project Units), and 227 contractor/agency staff.

Key Focus Areas

The sessions featured technical presentations, interactive discussions focused on critical aspects of safe and quality execution of 2×25 kV upgradation works, including: **Personnel Safety**: General safety precautions, use of personal protective equipment (PPE), safe working practices and prevention of unsafe acts.

Safety of Railway Operations & Infrastructure: Safe operation of cranes, JCBs and excavators near railway tracks; protection of train operations, track, signalling and telecommunications (S&T) systems and other railway assets.

Quality in Construction & Erection: Safety and quality checks during foundation casting, mast erection, alignment and grouting, with emphasis on compliance with approved drawings, technical specifications and prescribed procedures.

OHE & PSI Works: Safe execution of Feeder Wire/AEC erection, BEC laying and associated works in proximity to existing railway infrastructure and energised OHE.

Emergency Preparedness: Precautions during adverse weather, emergency response procedures, accident reporting and rescue arrangements.

Roles & Accountability: Clear understanding of responsibilities and accountability of Railway officials, Project Unit personnel, supervisors and contractor staff in ensuring safe and quality execution.

Learning from Field Experiences: Sharing of safety incidents, near misses, practical challenges and lessons learned to identify potential hazards and prevent recurrence.

Outcomes & Way Forward

The campaign underscored that safety and quality are collective responsibilities. By bridging communication between Railway officials, project units, and contracting agencies, the camps promoted proactive hazard identification, strict adherence to technical standards, and continuous learning from field incidents.

Northern Railway remains firmly committed to ensuring these critical infrastructure projects are executed systematically, achieving the highest quality standards while prioritizing personnel safety, uninterrupted train operations, and asset protection under the guiding motto: Safety First • Quality Always • No Shortcuts • Zero Compromise

Delhi Govt employees' body backs EC on SIR, asks Opposition to apologise for questioning staff integrity

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Government Employees Welfare Association has asked political parties and other organisations to publicly apologise to government officials and employees working on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. It says their integrity has been questioned without evidence. The appeal was made in a press release dated October 13. The association also expressed support for the Election Commission of India and the Chief Election Commissioner. It urged that the integrity, impartiality and professional dignity of the officials and employees involved in the SIR be protected. It said they are public servants appointed by the government and remain honest and dutiful towards the people.

The body voiced concern over allegations made by representatives of political parties and other organisations about the SIR. These include claims that the names of eligible voters were removed from the voter list arbitrarily and that the process lacks transparency. The association said every genuine complaint should be examined on the basis of facts, records and the prescribed legal procedure. No allegation, it said, should be treated as established fact before an inquiry.

The association pointed to the role of government staff in the SIR. In the field work, it said, Electoral Registration Officers, Assistant Electoral Registration Officers, Booth Level Officers, Booth Level Supervisors and other officials and employees posted from various departments play an important part. All of them verify voter details and carry out other election-related duties under the guidelines set by the Election Commission.

According to the association, questioning the collective honesty, integrity and impartiality of government staff without adequate evidence is hurting their morale and dignity. It said that if irregularity is proved in a specific case, action should be taken as per rules. But such an allegation against the integrity of employees in Delhi and other states is not justified, it said.

The association appealed to leaders of Opposition parties to place proof of their allegations before the competent authorities. It said their public statements have badly hurt the collective reputation and integrity of government officials and employees. It therefore asked all Opposition parties and other organisations to apologise publicly to all government employees.

The body also proposed a series of democratic programmes in support of the dignity and integrity of government staff. These include a candle march or peaceful march from the Delhi Secretariat to Rajghat and the submission of a memorandum to the competent authorities.

The association said all such events would be held peacefully and in a disciplined manner, in line with the required permissions and applicable legal provisions. The association made it clear that it does not oppose the examination of any genuine complaint. Its aim, it said, is to protect the reputation of all government employees who perform their duties honestly.

It stressed that it wants impartial inquiry and evidence-based accountability.

It appealed to all Opposition parties and the concerned parties of other organisations to respect democratic institutions and maintain responsible public dialogue. It also asked them to help keep up the morale and dignity of all officials and employees engaged in election work.

The bird that had to raise its voice

SANDEEP JOSHI



Stand on the trail above Chopta on a spring morning and you may catch it: a sharp, ringing whistle from the slope, followed by a flash of colour as a male monal bursts out of the rhododendrons. In the right light his feathers shift from emerald to sapphire to burnished copper, as if someone had dipped him in molten metal. Locals in Garhwal have long treated the bird as part of the mountain itself. It is Uttarakhand's state bird and Nepal's national bird, and it appears in folk songs and village stories across the range.

But listen closely, and the monal in Chopta no longer sounds quite like it used to.

Singing over the traffic

Researchers at Hemvati Nandan Bahuguna Garhwal University spent a year, starting April 2023, listening to monals in two valleys of the Kedarnath Musk Deer Sanctuary. One was Chopta, a busy stop on the pilgrim and trekking circuit, where taxis, bikes and tour groups fill the road for much of the season. The other was Madmaheshwar, still reached mainly on foot and largely quiet.

Using microphones and passive recorders, Dr Rajeev Lochan, Dinesh Kumar Sharma and Anand Kumar captured more than 700 calls. The difference was clear. Chopta's birds called at a higher pitch and in shorter bursts, apparently to cut through the low drone of engines and voices. It is something like trying to talk to a friend across a crowded railway platform: you raise your voice, keep it short, and hope the message gets through.

The change is too slight for most of us to hear. For the birds, it may not be trivial. Calls are how monals court mates and warn off rivals, and a signal lost in the noise can mean a missed chance to breed. Lochan stresses that this is behavioural flexibility, not an evolutionary shift. The bird is coping. The question is how long coping is enough.

Climbing until there is nowhere left

A second study by the same lead researcher looked further ahead. Using the climate models and emission scenarios relied upon by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, the team projected how the monal's habitat in Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh could change until 2100.

The picture is of a bird being nudged steadily uphill. As snowlines retreat and vegetation moves higher, the monal follows. At the same time, people are crowding into the alpine meadows that were once its refuge. The trouble is simple geometry: mountains get narrower towards the top. Higher ground means smaller, broken-up patches of habitat, populations cut off from one another, and a growing risk of local extinction.

Because the monal shifts between lower forests and high meadows through the year, scientists see it as a kind of early-warning system for the whole ecosystem. Environmental practitioner Vishal Singh points out that if a hardy, adaptable bird is being forced to change both its voice and its home, more fragile species are likely faring worse.

A pattern across the range

The monal is not alone. In Ladakh and Spiti, packs of free-ranging dogs, fed on scraps from hotels, camps and roadside dhabas, now hunt young bharal and ibex and compete with snow leopards for prey. Near Dras and Kargil, Himalayan brown bears have taken to raiding open garbage dumps, drawing them uncomfortably close to people. In Sikkim, Darjeeling and Arunachal Pradesh, the shy red panda is losing forest to new roads and settlements, its habitat chopped into ever smaller pieces.

Uttarakhand has already had painful reminders of what happens when building outpaces caution. The Chamoli disaster of 2021, which tore through hydropower sites, and the sinking of Joshimath in 2023 showed how unforgiving these slopes can be. Meanwhile, the Char Dham pilgrimage now draws visitors in the millions each season, bringing more vehicles, more waste and more noise into valleys that were remote within living memory.

Growth without balance

None of this is an argument against roads, livelihoods or pilgrimage. Mountain communities need incomes, and tourism provides many of them. But as Singh notes, the region's economic growth has drifted out of step with what its ecology can bear.

Anjal Prakash of FLAME University, who has contributed to IPCC reports, believes human pressure is "rewriting the rules of life in the Himalaya."

Lochan's team calls its work preliminary, and more research is needed to understand the long-term effects. Yet the bird on the Chopta slope has already sent its message, in a slightly higher key than before. The mountains need space and quiet. Whether we are willing to give them some is now the real question.

The writer is a freelance journalist

DGR & Corporate HR conclave held in Guwahati for ex-servicemen

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Guwahati



The Directorate General Resettlement (DGR), through its Directorate of Resettlement Zone (East), organised a DGR & Corporate HR Conclave on 13 October 2026 at the Directorate of Sainik Welfare, Government of Assam, Guwahati, with the objective of strengthening collaboration between the Armed Forces, DGR and the corporate sector for enhanced employment and resettlement opportunities for Ex-Servicemen (ESM).

The Conclave brought together representatives from around 40 leading corporate houses and industry organisations, including ITC, Taj Group, CII, ACCI, Aditya Birla, TVS, IIT and other prominent organisations, besides senior Army officials and representatives from DGR.

The event provided an important platform for interaction between the corporate sector and the resettlement ecosystem. Presentations focused on the skills, leadership qualities, discipline, integrity and professional experience of Ex-Servicemen and the opportunities available for their meaningful absorption in the corporate sector.

Lt Gen Pranab Kumar Bharali, VSM, Retd delivered the Keynote Address to the gathering, followed by a detailed presentation by Brigadier Saumya Banerjee, Sena Medal & Bar, Directorate of Resettlement Zone (East), highlighting the significant contribution made by Ex-Servicemen to the nation and emphasising that their extensive experience in leadership, administration, logistics, security, operations and team management makes them a valuable human resource for corporate organisations. The Conclave also provided an opportunity to sensitise corporate HR leaders about the various resettlement initiatives, employment facilitation measures, skill development and reorientation programmes undertaken by DGR for Ex-Servicemen.

The interaction reaffirmed the importance of public-private partnership in the resettlement of Ex-Servicemen and in creating sustainable second-career opportunities for them after their service in the Armed Forces, marking another significant step towards bridging the gap between ESM and the Corporate Sector.

RITES exports first 18-coach rake to Bangladesh Railway

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Transport infrastructure consultancy and engineering company RITES Ltd on Tuesday said it has dispatched the first rake of 18 broad-gauge passenger coaches to Bangladesh Railway, as part of a contract for supplying 200 passenger coaches. The coaches, comprising seven variants, are being manufactured by Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, Punjab.

The first rake, dispatched on October 12, 2026, comprises 11 non-AC shovan chair cars, three AC chair cars, two AC sleeper cars, and two AC power cars equipped with a guard room and luggage space, it said. The company said it has supplied over 280 locomotives and more than 1,085 coaches & diesel multiple unit (DMU) trainsets.

A navratna public sector enterprise, RITES has undertaken projects in over 55 countries in Asia, Africa, Latin America, South America, and West Asia.



GDA conducts site inspection to explore connectivity between PWD guest house, Bhatia Mod and Thakurdwara flyover



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Ghaziabad

A team comprising the Secretary of the Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA), the Officer-in-Charge of the Chief Engineer's office, and other engineers conducted a site inspection on October 12, 2026, along with the Project Director, Deputy Manager, and engineers of the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) to assess the technical feasibility of the proposed traffic connectivity projects.

During the inspection, the team explored the possibility of widening the existing Thakurdwara Flyover to four lanes over a stretch of approximately one kilometre and connecting it to Bhatia Mod. Discussions were also held regarding the construction of an approximately three-kilometre-long elevated road from Bhatia Mod to the PWD Guest House.

Additionally, the proposal to develop connectivity towards Noida through a double-decker flyover beyond the Railway Overbridge (ROB), crossing over the Delhi–Meerut Expressway (DME), was discussed. The proposed infrastructure aims to alleviate traffic congestion near Lal Kuan and ensure smooth traffic movement in the region for the next 50 years.

To assess the technical feasibility of the proposed projects and examine issues such as utility shifting involving various departments, a meeting will soon be convened under the chairmanship of Vice-Chairman, GDA, with representatives from NHAI, Electricity Department, UPSIDA, and other concerned departments. The meeting will focus on resolving the obstacles that may hinder flyover construction so that the project can commence at the earliest. Further action will be determined based on technical findings and coordination among concerned departments.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

Internationalising higher education
to make a difference to work, culture and society

International higher education is evolving through multidisciplinary teaching, collaborative research and industry engagement. By connecting academic learning with real-world challenges, this approach aims to equip students with the knowledge and skills needed for a globally connected future





KEN BADCOCK
Interim Vice-Chancellor and President, University of York

It was very exciting to meet the first cohort of students at the University of York Mumbai at the start of the academic year; their energy, ambition and enthusiasm were inspiring. They had many interesting questions for us about the values of the University, our research, and what we hope for the future. But since we announced our intention to set up the University, one of the most common questions we have received is: why is York in Mumbai, and what do we want to achieve together?

One response to this is that the Government of India's New Education Policy of 2020 identified a role for international universities like York in meeting policy objectives in India. With the vitality of India, shifting government policies globally and expanded student choice, the opportunity was an attractive one for York.

However, York's motivation goes much deeper than this, deriving from being international to our core — in the staff and student body, our research networks, our outlook, standards and academic ambition. When the University was founded in the 1960s, it was stated that the institution was created to educate "citizens of the world". We are restless to make this mean more.

A campus in Mumbai creates new academic opportunities: for students and staff in York and India to learn together and about each other, whether in person or virtually; for York programmes to be contextualised for Mumbai, and for this to influence what we teach in York; for joint research programmes drawing on the different contexts; and for York to learn from the different expectations in India around topics like internships and student induction.

To establish the University, we have focused on a number of aspects as key to realising these opportunities. First, an excellent learning environment has been established in Powai, providing flexible spaces for individual and team-based learning which encourage interaction and questioning. Secondly, academic staff were recruited by York panels to York standards, attracting staff from around the world to Powai. Thirdly, the York programmes have been contextualised for Mumbai, with the same learning outcomes achieved through locally relevant examples and case studies.

Importantly, we are building research alongside education to provide an environment of discovery for learning, and to attract and retain the best academic staff. The opportunity to consider applications relevant to Mumbai, combining expertise from York and Mumbai, is exciting. Our recently launched Institute for Good Society aims to do this. The research and policy institute aims to contribute to the current and future challenges society faces. Its four areas of work — Business, Finance and Economy; Creative Culture; Environment; and Technology - connect academic research with questions being confronted by businesses, communities and policymakers.



Mumbai is central to this proposition. Rather than treating the city simply as a location for a university, the Institute sees it as a living lab: a place where researchers can work with businesses, communities and policymakers on questions around urbanisation, sustainability, technology, economic development and cultural transformation.

This approach to research is also reflected in our teaching at the University of York Mumbai. Areas such as computer science, artificial intelligence and cyber security sit alongside business, finance and the creative industries. These disciplines reflect fields where technology, economic change and societal questions increasingly intersect, and where the skills of our students will be most effective in looking at a problem from every angle. The Business of Creative Industries, for example, brings together creativity and business in a sector being reshaped by digital technologies, new forms of storytelling and changing models of cultural production.

> "THE UNIVERSITY AIMS TO CONNECT INTERNATIONAL ACADEMIC STANDARDS WITH INDIA'S EDUCATIONAL AND RESEARCH NEEDS THROUGH MULTIDISCIPLINARY LEARNING, INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENT AND COLLABORATIVE RESEARCH

The relationship with industry is similarly changing. At the University of York Mumbai, industry engagement is intended to inform learning itself. Finance professionals, for example, have contributed to discussions on the skills the sector needs, while industry professionals with academic roles contribute to teaching. Compulsory internships provide another bridge between academic knowledge and professional practice. The University of York Mumbai has its first cohort of students and staff, and the work to realise the potential set out above is under way.

Design emerges as India's next strategic profession

SIDDHARTH SHAHANI
Executive President, ATLAS SkillTech University

Design in India is entering its most expansive phase yet. What was once associated mainly with fashion, products and interiors now shapes how people bank, shop, learn, travel and receive care. From the interface of a payment app to the layout of a hospital ward and the experience of a retail brand, design has become central to how organisations create value and how people experience everyday life.

This growth reflects a wider shift in the economy. As businesses compete on experience as much as on price or features, design has moved from the studio to the strategy table. Companies across technology, consumer goods, media, real estate and healthcare now see designers as partners in innovation, not only as specialists who arrive at the final stage.

A profession of expanding possibilities

The numbers point to significant opportunities. India's fashion and luxury market is projected to reach $85-90 billion by 2030. The creator economy is expected to influence nearly a trillion dollars in consumer spending over the same period, and the real estate sector is projected to exceed $920 billion by 2031. Each of these sectors will need professionals who can combine creative insight with commercial understanding and technological fluency.

New roles are emerging as a result. AI product designers, service designers, design engineers and experience strategists are becoming integral to how organisations build products and services. The professionals who will lead in this sector can move confidently between aesthetics and analytics, and between human behaviour and business outcomes.

Education rises to the moment

The National Education Policy's emphasis on multidisciplinary learning has encouraged institutions to align design education with this broader definition of the profession. Leading institutions are responding by restructuring their programmes around the domains where design creates impact.

ISDI at ATLAS SkillTech University, known for introducing one of India's first undergraduate programmes integrating design thinking with business strategy, reflects this direction in its 2027 undergraduate offering. It is organised across five domains: product and technology, fashion and commerce, communication and media, space and environment, and business and entrepreneurship. Emerging disciplines such as AI-integrated product design and health and care design sit alongside established ones.



The road ahead

For students considering design, the opportunity has never been broader. A design education today can lead to careers in technology firms, global brands, media houses, healthcare systems and entrepreneurial ventures. Programmes that offer exposure to technology, business and real-world industry challenges are equipping students to build careers with long-term relevance.

As India's economy grows more innovation-led, design is poised to play a defining role in it. The next generation of designers will do more than serve industries; they will shape them.

> "DESIGN HAS BECOME ONE OF THE MOST POWERFUL TOOLS AN ECONOMY HAS FOR INNOVATION," SAYS SIDDHARTH SHAHANI, EXECUTIVE PRESIDENT, ATLAS SKILLTECH UNIVERSITY. "THE DESIGNERS INDIA NEEDS WILL BRING TOGETHER CREATIVITY, TECHNOLOGY AND BUSINESS THINKING WITH EQUAL CONFIDENCE. PREPARING THEM MEANS BUILDING EDUCATION AROUND WHERE THE PROFESSION IS HEADING, SO THAT OUR GRADUATES DO NOT JUST ENTER INDUSTRIES BUT HELP SHAPE THEM."

Navigating modern finance career paths

SUSHMA VISHNANI
Director, Jaipuria Institute of Management, Lucknow

Ask most MBA students about their dream finance job, and many will still say, "investment banking". It remains a respected and sought-after career path. But look at how companies are hiring on campuses today, and a much broader picture emerges. Finance careers now extend far beyond the traditional deal table, with two forces playing an increasingly important role in reshaping the landscape: Global Capability Centres (GCCs) and artificial intelligence (AI).

Global banks, asset managers and multinational companies have steadily expanded their finance operations through Global Capability Centres (GCCs) in India. These centres are no longer limited to traditional back-office functions. They increasingly handle financial planning and analysis, treasury, valuation, risk analytics, regulatory reporting and investment research for global markets. For MBA graduates, GCCs can offer valuable early-career exposure to global operations, complex financial products and specialised functions, along with opportunities for professional growth, all without having to leave India. As these centres take on more strategic responsibilities, finance roles within GCCs are becoming an increasingly important career option for management graduates.

How AI Is Changing Finance

Private credit and alternative investments are creating opportunities in financial modelling, portfolio monitoring and the valuation of unlisted assets. Banking remains one of the major recruiters of MBA graduates, with opportunities ranging from relationship management and credit analysis to trade finance. Compliance, risk management and anti-money-laundering functions are also witnessing growing demand as regulatory requirements become more complex across global markets. Fintech is creating opportunities for managers who can understand both financial products and technology, while rural and inclusive finance offers careers that combine business growth with broader social impact.



Strong foundations in accounting, valuation and credit analysis remain essential. Alongside these, employers increasingly expect data skills such as advanced Excel, SQL, Python and Power BI, together with the ability to use AI confidently and responsibly. Human skills matter just as much. Clear communication, ownership, sound risk judgement and integrity can set professionals apart as technology takes over more routine tasks. In finance, trust remains the real currency.

> FINANCE CAREERS ARE EXPANDING BEYOND TRADITIONAL INVESTMENT BANKING ROLES

Business schools must keep pace with these changes. Students need live industry projects, hands-on experience with market data, exposure to AI tools and their limitations, and electives in fintech, private markets and risk management. Partnerships with GCCs and financial firms can also help students understand how global finance teams operate and what employers expect from management graduates.

At Jaipuria Institute of Management, this approach has been translated into industry-led opportunities for students. Students were selected for a Financial Crime Risk Management programme with Genpact, designed as a training-to-hiring model. The programme was jointly delivered by the institute and Genpact professionals, with students undergoing continuous evaluation by the organisation. The initiative subsequently led to full-time employment opportunities as analysts for selected students.

Students have also received opportunities in specialised areas such as Business Science, Marketing Associate roles, and Future & Risk, with organisations including AGEP India, Decimal Point and Kotak Investment Bank. Such experiences demonstrate the value of connecting classroom learning with specialised industry requirements and emerging areas of finance.

Investment banking will continue to have its place in the finance profession. But with GCCs creating opportunities linked to global finance operations in India and AI reshaping the work done by finance professionals, today's management graduates have a much broader range of career pathways to consider.

Building strong domain knowledge, working effectively with AI and earning trust through sound judgement will be increasingly important.

The changing hiring landscape is already visible on B-school campuses. At Jaipuria Institute of Management, the GCC talent pool has included recruiters such as BlackRock, Berkadia, BNY, ADP, FactSet, Ameriprise and Cvent. Their presence reflects the expanding range of finance, analytics and business roles available beyond traditional financial-services careers. The map of finance careers is no longer defined by a handful of conventional destinations. For students and business schools alike, the opportunity lies in understanding where the industry is moving and preparing for it accordingly.

Breaking the silence on mental health

N KRUSHNAVENI
Student Counselor, VNR Vignana Jyothi Institute of Engineering and Technology

Mental health is an essential part of a student's overall well-being, influencing academic performance, relationships, confidence and personal growth. For many years, mental health difficulties were surrounded by silence, misconceptions and fear of judgement. Students experiencing anxiety, stress, depression or emotional struggles often hesitated to seek help because they worried about being misunderstood or labelled as weak. Today, however, a positive change is emerging: more students are beginning to speak openly about their mental health and recognise the importance of seeking support.

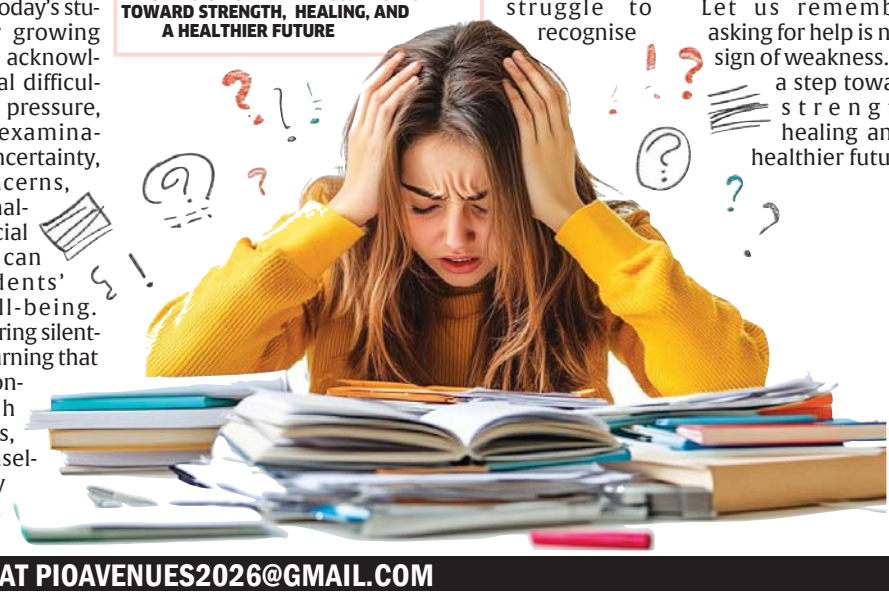
One of the most encouraging developments among today's students is their growing willingness to acknowledge emotional difficulties. Academic pressure, competitive examinations, career uncertainty, financial concerns, relationship challenges and social expectations can affect students' mental well-being. Instead of suffering silently, many are learning that sharing their concerns with trusted friends, teachers, counsellors or family members can help them cope more effectively.

Social media, mental health awareness campaigns, student support groups and educational institutions have contributed to making conversations about mental health more visible. Discussions about stress management, emotional resilience, mindfulness and counselling are gradually becoming more common. Students increasingly understand that experiencing emotional difficulties is not a personal failure but a part of being human.

Friends can help students feel understood and encourage open conversations about anxiety and emotional distress. However, peer support should complement professional help when needed. Colleges can support students through accessible counselling services, awareness programmes and stress-management workshops. Counsellors can guide students in developing coping strategies, managing academic pressure, building self-confidence and addressing personal challenges. Institutions should also discourage bullying, discrimination and insensitive comments about mental health. Seeking counselling must be viewed as a responsible step towards well-being rather than a source of embarrassment.

Although attitudes are changing, stigma has not disappeared completely. Some students continue to fear being judged by classmates, disappointing their families or appearing incapable of handling responsibilities. Others may struggle to recognise their symptoms or know where to seek help.

> LET US REMEMBER: ASKING FOR HELP IS NOT A SIGN OF WEAKNESS. IT IS A STEP TOWARD STRENGTH, HEALING, AND A HEALTHIER FUTURE



Therefore, awareness must go beyond occasional campaigns. Mental health education should encourage early help-seeking, emotional literacy and respectful conversations throughout the academic year.

The cracking of mental health stigma represents an important step towards healthier campuses and stronger communities. Speaking up does not mean weakness; it demonstrates courage, self-awareness and a willingness to grow.

Every student deserves to feel heard, respected and supported. By listening with empathy, challenging misconceptions and making professional support accessible, we can build a college culture where no student feels alone in their struggles.

Let us remember: asking for help is not a sign of weakness. It is a step towards strength, healing and a healthier future.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026

Fresh Saudi airstrikes hit oil sites near Yemen Capital

FATMA KHALED ■ Cairo

The Saudi-led coalition carried out new airstrikes on oil facilities west of Sanaa, according to Houthi-linked broadcaster Al Masirah and residents of Yemen's Capital.

The strikes marked a fresh escalation in the widening West Asia crisis and came shortly after a coalition spokesman urged residents to evacuate the area for their safety. Witnesses in Sanaa reported hearing explosions. It was not immediately clear which facilities were hit.

In a rare statement, the coalition urged civilians in the Houthi-controlled capital to leave the Yemeni Oil Company site and nearby storage areas ahead of a possible strike. Houthi officials appeared to anticipate an attack on the site. The oil company said its storage facilities were empty and that a Saudi strike would not affect oil reserves or supplies for residents.


Truck loaded with firewood drives through the Al-Basateen neighborhood in Aden AP

Shortly after the warning, Houthi military spokesman Brig. Gen. Yahya Saree said on Telegram that any Saudi attack on Sanaa would be met with a "firm and painful" response in Riyadh.

The area to be evacuated in western Sanaa, al-Subaha, is on a hill overlooking the capital. It is not a populated area, but the fuel station nearby is used by the public. The back-and-forth threats come as Saudi Arabia is scrambling to determine how its air defences failed to intercept a barrage of missiles and drones fired by the Houthis, including an attack on Riyadh's international airport on Saturday that killed at least 13 people and wounded over 300.

The latest conflict between the Saudis and the Houthis began last month after the rebels seized key areas along the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a critical waterway for the transport of Gulf oil and other goods at the southern end of the Red Sea off Yemen.

The Saudi-led coalition, backing forces aligned with Yemen's internationally recognised government, has been trying to retake them.

Earlier Tuesday, the Houthis renewed their warning against using Saudi airspace, Houthi-controlled media reported. Several airlines have suspended service to the kingdom because of the Houthi attacks on airports.

In a statement published by the Houthi-controlled SABA news agency, the Houthi-run foreign ministry referred to Saudi Arabia as the "Kingdom of the Horn of Satan" and said the kingdom "must realise that security, stability, and sovereignty must belong to everyone; otherwise, no one will enjoy them."

Meanwhile, Egyptian Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty called for the Houthis to immediately halt attacks on Saudi Arabia. "There is no justification for these attacks, and they cannot be accepted," Abdelatty told Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in a phone call Tuesday. (*AP*)

Pope Leo XIV arrives at Gemelli hospital ahead of surgery



NICOLE WINFIELD/ COLLEEN BARRY ■ Rome

Pope Leo XIV was admitted to Rome's Gemelli hospital on Tuesday ahead of surgery later in the day to remove a lung nodule, an operation that experts say will determine whether the lesion is malignant and if other treatment is needed.

After the quick drive from the Vatican, Leo walked into the hospital through the main entrance and waved to dozens of well-wishers who had gathered to greet him. The Vatican said the surgery would be performed later in the afternoon by a team led by Gemelli's chief thoracic surgeon, Dr Stefano Margaritora. The 71-year-old American pontiff has offered a rare level of transparency about the first publicly disclosed major health problem of his 17-month papacy. He revealed the discovery of the small, localised nodule during his Sunday noon prayer and announced that he would have it removed.

Oncologists say even if the nodule turns out to be cancerous, Leo's prognosis is "excellent" since it will have been removed at an early stage. The surgery, which is usually performed under general anesthesia, will require a weeklong hospital stay and the Vatican on Monday cancelled all Leo's audiences through October 20. (*AP*)

Iran targeting military sites, suspected plot at RAF Fairford not unique: MI5


Ken McCallum

JILL LAWLESS ■ London

Iran is trying to hit military sites in the UK and the suspected plot to attack a US-run military air base in September is "not unique," the head of Britain's MI5 spy agency said Tuesday.

Ken McCallum, who leads the UK's domestic security service, said Tehran is seeking to intensify its attacks in Britain beyond the traditional targets of Iranians opposed to the country's Islamic authorities.

That has included arson and sabotage attacks on Jewish sites that Britain says were carried out by Iranian proxies. McCallum said another "major shift this year has been Iranian ambitions to come at harder targets, like military sites."

The incident at RAF Fairford "is not unique. There have been other examples, not just in the UK but around the world," McCallum said. McCallum delivered a speech outlining major threats to the UK as detectives probe a suspected terror plot against the US-run base in western England, which has been used to bomb Iran during this year's war. Scores of residents were evacuated from their homes near the base on September 27 as armed police officers and army bomb-disposal experts swarmed the rural area. Police later said they had found a quantity of an accelerant - gasoline - in three vans at the site, but no explosives.

Indian airlines cancel Saudi flights until october 17

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



IndiGo, Air India, Air India Express and Akasa Air on Tuesday announced the cancellation or suspension of flights connecting major Saudi Arabian cities until October 17 amid an evolving security situation in the region.

The decision comes after a series of reported attacks in Saudi Arabia in recent days, including an attack at Riyadh airport. The airlines said they were closely monitoring developments and prioritising passenger safety amid rising security concerns. IndiGo announced on social media platform X that flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah would remain cancelled until October 17 due to the evolving situation in Saudi Arabia.

Air India Express also confirmed the suspension of services to and from Dammam, Jeddah and Riyadh until October 17. The airline said affected passengers could opt for complimentary rescheduling or a full refund on cancellation.

"In view of the evolving situation in the region, we have cancelled flights to and from Dammam, Jeddah and Riyadh until 17 October," the airline said in a statement, adding that it would continue to monitor the situation closely. Air India announced the cancellation of flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah until October 17. The airline said it was assessing developments in the region and would resume safe operations when conditions permitted. It also offered affected passengers a full refund on cancellation.

Meanwhile, Akasa Air extended the suspension of all flights to and from Riyadh and Jeddah until October 17, citing the escalating security situation in the Middle East and the associated risks to safe flight operations.

In a post on X, Akasa Air said the decision followed a careful assessment of the evolving situation, with passenger and operational safety remaining its primary consideration. The airline added that it was monitoring developments in real time. Last week, airlines temporarily suspended services to Riyadh following reports of attacks at the city's airport, reportedly involving Houthi militants.

Tensions involving the Iran-backed Houthi group and Saudi Arabia have intensified, with reports of attacks involving armed drones and missiles raising concerns over regional security.

The latest suspensions are expected to affect passengers travelling between India and Saudi Arabia.

Travellers scheduled to fly on the affected routes are advised to check directly with their respective airlines for the latest flight updates, rescheduling options and refund policies.

Greta backs French school protests over run-down schools



JOHN LEICESTER ■ Saint-Denis

Greta Thunberg on Tuesday threw her high-profile support behind high school protesters rattling the government in France, saying "the whole world is watching with awe."

She joined and applauded hundreds of teenagers who demonstrated boisterously outside their school north of Paris under the watchful eye of police. The surprise appearance of the 23-year-old Swedish activist, best known for raising awareness about the climate crisis, and another day of marches in the French capital together suggested that the high-schoolers' push for more resources for run-down schools is far from running out of steam. That's despite mass arrests, mounting injuries and the fatigue from more than three weeks of blockading and demonstrating outside schools.

Outside the Paul Eluard high school in Saint-Denis, where staff and students have long complained of dilapidated facilities and even rat infestations, Thunberg said French pupils are "fighting back, reclaiming their future that has been taken away from them" and are inspiring young people in other countries. (*AP*)

Bangladesh Govt warns of action after Yunus heckled in New York

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dhaka



An adviser to Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman on Tuesday warned of "legal action" after former interim government chief Muhammad Yunus was heckled by purported supporters of the disbanded Awami League at New York's John F. Kennedy Airport. "It will not go unchallenged," Zahed Ur Rahman told a media briefing, hours after Yunus faced the hecklers shouting aggressive slogans, which went viral on social media. The Bangladesh PM's information and broadcasting adviser said the government viewed the incidents as "Awami League terror" and "definitely legal proceedings will be initiated against those committing this offence"."I want to tell the Awami League members living in different countries that if they attempt such actions, they will not go unchallenged. There is no question of that," Zahed said, referring to the case of actress and activist Ajmeria Haque Badhon who was harassed in Italy.

A key aide in the past interim regime, Lamiya Morshed, was seen walking alongside Yunus carrying his luggage, while another man was driving him in a wheelchair as he was coming out of the airport.

The protestors emerged at the scene and shouted, "You are a terrorist, murderer!" "Why you come here?", and "You killed thousands of police officers in my country", when Yunus looked bewildered and remained silent.

Trump's Greece envoy resigns over misconduct allegations

MATTHEW LEEAP ■ Washington


Kimberly Guilfoyle

President Donald Trump's ambassador to Greece, Kimberly Guilfoyle, resigned on Tuesday after allegations of improper conduct but insisted she'll "vigorously defend" herself.

Trump's administration said Tuesday it had asked her to leave her post after she faced severe criticism over allegations she engaged in improper and possibly illegal conduct before and during her tenure in Athens.

The announcement, after days of comments and speculation, came in response to a question to freshly minted White House press secretary Katie Zacharia at her first media briefing Tuesday morning. Zacharia said Guilfoyle "has been a wonderful asset to the team, and we wish her well."

Guilfoyle's departure comes after its possibility was previewed to the AP over the weekend and Trump registered his unhappiness on Monday at reports about her alleged conduct. "Well, we're looking at it," Trump told reporters at the White House when asked if he was considering firing Guilfoyle. Those comments came a day after the AP, citing a senior US official, reported that Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio are "extremely pissed off" by Guilfoyle's reported conduct and would likely decide on her future this week. (*AP*)

PRESS NOTICE
নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী

The Chief Engineer, P.W.D (Building), Assam on behalf of the Governor of Assam invites bids from Govt. registered eligible Contractors having experience in similar nature of works for the following work.

Details of bid may be seen at e-procurement portal www.assamtenders.gov.in. The bidders must be enrolled in www.assamtenders.gov.in

অসম চৰকাৰৰ ৰাজ্যপালৰ পক্ষৰ পৰা মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নির্মাণ বিভাগ (ভৱন), অসমে একে ধৰণৰ কামৰ অভিজ্ঞতা থকা চৰকাৰীভাৱে পঞ্জীয়নভুক্ত যোগ্য ঠিকাদাৰসকলৰ পৰা তলত উল্লেখিত কামৰ বাবে নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰিছে।

নিবিদাৰ বিৱৰণ e-procurement portal www.assamtenders.gov.in ত চাব পাৰিব। নিবিদাদাতাসকল www.assamtenders.gov.in ত নামভর্তি হোৱা বাধ্যতামূলক।

Sl. No. ক্ৰ. নং	Name of work কামৰ নাম	Approx. Value of work (in Rs) কামৰ আনুমানিক মূল্য (টকাত)	Bid Security নিবিদা পত্ৰ সুৰক্ষা	Bid Processing Fee নিবিদা প্ৰক্ৰিয়াকৰণ মূল্য (টকাত)	Completion period সম্পূৰ্ণ কৰাৰ সময়সীমা
1. ১.	Development and upgradation of Batadava Than at Barduwa,Nagaon (Phase-II) বৰদোৱাস্থিত বটদ্ৰৱা থানৰ উন্নয়ন আৰু নৱীকৰণ (দ্বিতীয় পর্যায়)	Rs. 14,00,43,473.00 ₹১৪,০০,৪৩,৪৭৩.০০	For General category, Rs. 28,00,869.00 and For Reserved category Rs. 14,00,435.00 সাধাৰণ শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে ₹ ₹২৮,০০,৮৬৯.০০ আৰু সংৰক্ষিত শ্ৰেণীৰ বাবে ₹১৪,০০,৪৩৫.০০	Rs 20,000.00 টকা ২০,০০০.০০	20 months ২০ মাহ

Note টিপ্পনি:
(i) Value of work may vary according to the detail NIT. কামৰ মূল্য বিতংভাৱে আহ্বান কৰা নিবিদা জাননী অনুযায়ী পৰিৱর্তন হ'ব পাৰে।
(ii) All terms and conditions will be as per the Bidding Documents. সকলো চর্ত আৰু নিয়মাৱলী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰ অনুযায়ী হ'ব।
(iii) The Press Notice will be a part of the Bidding Documents. নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী নিবিদা নথিপত্ৰৰ অংশ হ'ব।

Chief Engineer, PWD (Building)
Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-3

মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নির্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ,
অসম, চান্দমাৰি, গুৱাহাটী-৩

DIPR/C/PIO/143/14-Oct-26

सार्वजनिक सूचना

तालाबों के पट्टे छोड़े जाने हेतु नीलामी नोटिस सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि ग्राम पंचायत बीबीपुर, खंड नूंह, जिला नूंह (हरियाणा) के अंतर्गत आने वाले तालाबों को निर्धारित नियमों एवं शर्तों के अनुसार पट्टे पर छोड़े जाने हेतु दिनांक 28 अक्टूबर 2026 (बुधवार) को प्रातः 10:00 बजे सार्वजनिक स्थान पर खुली बोली/नीलामी आयोजित की जाएगी। अतः सभी इच्छुक व्यक्ति निर्धारित तिथि, समय एवं स्थान पर उपस्थित होकर नीलामी में भाग ले सकते हैं।

आदेशानुसार
सरपंच
ग्राम पंचायत बीबीपुर
खंड नूंह, जिला नूंह (हरियाणा)

गाज़ियाबाद विकास प्राधिकरण
(ISO 9001:2015 एवं ISO 14001:2015 प्रमाणित संस्था)
विकास पथ, गाज़ियाबाद

पत्रांक: 696/पी0ए0–टी0/2026-27 दिनांक: 13.10.2026

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

उपाध्यक्ष, गाजियाबाद विकास प्राधिकरण की ओर से 11 कार्यों हेतु ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा सम्बन्धी समस्त विवरण व शर्ते गाजियाबाद विकास प्राधिकरण की वैबसाइट **www.gdaghaziabad.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं एवं UPLC की वैबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर निविदा विक्रय की तिथि में उपलब्ध होंगी। सम्बन्धित निविदा को ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना में उनके सम्मुख दर्शायी गयी तिथियों पर डाउनलोड व अपलोड किया जा सकता है एवं प्राप्त ई–निविदा को उनके सम्मुख दर्शायी गयी तिथियों पर खोला जायेगा। निविदा में कोई भी संशोधन / परिमार्जन / परिवर्तन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं को वैबसाइट पर ही प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।

मुख्य अभियन्ता

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एक सुन्दर शहर..... हमारा संकल्प

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION
Lokaseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Email ID: hedsec.od@od.gov.in
HE-GCNE-PLAN-0004-2024/ 53950 /H.E., Bhubaneswar, Dated: 07.10.2026

RFP CANCELLATION NOTICE
Addendum No.II

The notice for invitation of RFP for engagement of STATE PSU/ CENTRAL PSU/ DEPARTMENTAL UNDERTAKING as Project Management Consultant (PMC) for "CONSTRUCTION OF COMPLETE INFRASTRUCTURE FOR 18 NEWLY ESTABLISHED GOVERNMENT COLLEGES, ONE MDC UNDER RUSA, INFRASTRUCTURE FOR B.ED. COLLEGES, HOSTELS FOR 12 EXISTING GOVERNMENT HEIS, 20 HOSTELS FOR AIDED COLLEGES", floated vide this Department RFP No.GCNE:02/2026 Date:21.04.2026 stands cancelled with immediate effect.

Caption No- 11001/369/2627
OIPR- 11001/11001/1/2627/0073

Sd/-
Joint Secretary to Government

M.P. INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
SECRETARIAT FOR SINGLE WINDOW SYSTEM
CIN : U51102MP1977SGC001392
21, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011 M.P. (India), Tel. : (91) 755-2571830, 2575618, 3523555, 3523505, E-mail : helpdesk@mpidc.co.in, Web.: www.invest.mp.gov.in
MPIDC/CE/Tech-RFP/2026/290-292 Date : 13.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Madhya Pradesh Industrial Development Corporation Ltd. (MPIDC Ltd.) invites online percentage rate bids for the following work from registered contractors and firms for the following work :-

NIT No.	Name of Work	District	Probable Amount of Contract (in Rs. Cr.)
290	Shifting of Existing 33KV & 11KV Line at Mohasa Babai Industrial Area Phase-2, Narmadapuram	Narmadapuram	5.92
291	Upgradation of Existing Water Supply Scheme for Pilukhedi Industrial Area District Rajgarh	Rajgarh	13.75
292	Operation Maintenance & Security of Water Supply Scheme of Industrial Area Pithampur District Dhar (Second Call)	Dhar	24.77

The Tender documents can be downloaded from the e-procurement Portal- **https://mptenders.gov.in – MPIDC** HO shortly.
M.P. Madhyam/128574/2026 CHIEF ENGINEER

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, भदभदा रोड, संभाग भोपाल-01
Mobile No. 9425601545
Email ID : pe.policehousingbpl1@mp.gov.in
क्र.-मप्रपुआअविनि/1276/पयं/भोपाल-01/तशा/2026
भोपाल, दिनांक : 13.10.2026

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

भोपाल संभाग-01 अंतर्गत निर्माण कार्य 96 आरक्षक (Stilt+6) आवासगृह पुलिस लाइन शाहजहाँनाबाद एवं 64 आरक्षक (Stilt+8) आवासगृह खजूरी सड़क जिला भोपाल हेतु निविदा क्रमांक-19/2026-27 (ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक-542824, 542826 आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 06.11.2026 सायं 5:00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन खरीदे एवं दस्तावेज अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण **Portal : https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128571/2026 परियोजना यंत्री

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 14, 2026



India eye series win, WI fight for survival

HIMANK NEGI ■ Hyderabad

India's marauding batters would be eyeing another run feast against a West Indian attack that would have to do more than just be defensive when the two sides clash in the potentially series-deciding fourth T20 International here on Wednesday.

India need a win to seal the five-match rubber by going 3-1 up, while the West Indies would be desperate to draw level at 2-2 to keep the series alive.

The battle on ground is once again expected to be decided predominantly by the power-hitters in both sides.

The hosts will bank on a line-up whose top order is in great form. The trio of Sanju Samson, Abhishek Sharma and Ishan Kishan has come good in turns to ensure that the Indian middle order has not been put under too much pressure in the series so far.



Abhishek smashed 69 off just 30 balls in the third T20I in Indore, striking six fours and five sixes to help India post a winning 223-run total.

The only concern for the home team would be a relative lack of game time for the middle order due to the top three's brilliant run.

The likes of Tilak Varma, Nitish Kumar Reddy and Naman Dhir would have to be up for the challenge in case the top three have an off day, especially in a scenario where the team is chasing a big target.

The West Indies, on the other hand, have been struggling to find a way to contain the Indian juggernaut.

If it was skipper Shreyas Iyer, who took the lung-opener from them with his maiden T20I hundred, Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan proved to be difficult to handle in the second game that the visitors eventually won.

Abhishek dominated the proceedings in the third game and all-rounder Shamar Springer had no hesitation in acknowledging that his team had no option but to adopt a defensive approach against the on-song opener.

"...I guess our plan B is to just be as defensive as possible and try to make him get singles and twos," Springer had said, admitting how hard it is to stop Abhishek once he gets going.

For the Caribbeans, opener Sherfane Rutherford has had a terrific series, averaging over 57 for his 172 runs thus far at a brilliant strike rate of 189.

He has smacked 12 sixes in three games and is the leading run-getter in the rubber.

Skipper Shai Hope too has led by example and amassed 159 runs at a strike of 182 to make sure that the team's reputation of being a T20 batting powerhouse remains intact.

The visitors, in fact, have hardly been a pushover despite their lower ranking but they would need a stronger all-round performance to upstage the reigning world champions on home turf.

Nonetheless, India's bowling attack will have to remain disciplined as the West Indies batting unit has shown that it is capable of chasing big totals.

The team demonstrated its abilities quite well in the second T20 in Ranchi, where it chased down India's 249 in 18.3 overs thanks to Hope's 45-ball 102. (*PTI*)



India need to hunt for wickets, not contain West Indies, says Tilak

HIMANK NEGI ■ Hyderabad



India need to hunt for wickets rather than containing a power-packed West Indies batting line-up, vice-captain Tilak Varma said on Tuesday, stressing the importance of bowling plan execution as the hosts look to seal the five-match T20 International series in the fourth game itself.

India are 2-1 ahead in the series and a win on Wednesday will give them an unassailable lead, while the visitors will be eager to draw level.

The West Indies demonstrated their batting firepower by chasing down India's 249 in the second T20I, with skipper Shai Hope smashing a 45-ball 102.

Tilak said India ill afford to relax against a side whose power-hitting extends till the last batter in the line-up.

"The West Indies are a really good side, especially in T20 format. They play so much franchise cricket, so they know how to play this format. The power they have is unbelievable," Tilak said at the pre-match press conference on Tuesday.

"Everyone can hit the ball. It is not just the openers, number three or four. All their players can strike the ball, and even the 11th batter can come in and hit. Until all 10 wickets fall, the game is not over. We cannot relax."

India's bowling unit came under scrutiny after the second match defeat. The visitors capitalised in the powerplay to pull off a remarkable chase.

The 23-year-old Tilak said the team had reviewed its defensive approach in that match, with head coach Gautam Gambhir encouraging the bowlers to be more aggressive and to attack for wickets instead of allowing the opposition to dictate terms.

"Initially, in the second game, we did not go for wickets. We were slightly defensive when they (West Indies) were scoring runs. But after that, as a team, Gautam (Gambhir) sir also mentioned that we can go for wickets and show that aggression," he said.

India bounced back with a 14-run win in the third T20I in Indore, restricting the West Indies to 209 despite another late assault from the visitors.

Tilak said the team would look to build on that performance, with a better execution of plans against an opposition capable of changing the course of a match within a few overs.

With India's top batters in good form, the middle order has had limited opportunities. (*PTI*)



Powerplay costing West Indies against India, says coach Darren Sammy

HIMANK NEGI ■ Hyderabad

West Indies need to win both powerplays to beat India in India, head coach Darren Sammy said on Tuesday, identifying the first six overs as the decisive phase in the ongoing T20I series while backing experienced all-rounder Roston Chase amid criticism over his place in the side.

India lead the five-match series 2-1 ahead of the fourth T20 International here on Wednesday, with Sammy saying his side had repeatedly been forced to recover from expensive powerplays while bowling.

"I think the powerplay was the difference that prevented us from going 2-1 up, because we could have been 2-1 up as well," Sammy said.

He pointed out that India had scored at nearly 14.5 runs per over in the powerplay, despite West Indies restricting the scoring rate to below 10 runs an over in each of the subsequent three phases.

"For us, it is about controlling the powerplay. So far, we have had to pull the game back every single time. That is an area we need to work on," he said.

"To beat India in India, you really have to win both powerplays, with bat and ball." Sammy felt West Indies' batting had matched India's in the series, with his side also striking more sixes in some matches. He said the visitors had looked to make the most of batting-friendly conditions, knowing that such surfaces were not always available.

"When you play on good batting wickets, you always feel you are in the game. You are just two big overs away from getting yourself back into it," he said. The challenge, he added, was greater for the bowlers, with little margin for error on surfaces where totals of 200 or more are common.

"The margins are fine, but as we have seen, if you execute your skills, you are still in the contest," he said. (*PTI*)

Sri Lanka include Dhananjaya in Test squad for Pakistan series under new captain Mendis

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Colombo



Sri Lanka on Tuesday unveiled a 15-member squad for its upcoming ICC World Test Championship away series against Pakistan, marking Kusal Mendis' first stint as captain in the longest format for which his predecessor Dhananjaya de Silva will continue to remain in the side.

The 31-year-old Mendis, who already captains Sri Lanka's T20 and ODI teams, replaced de Silva a few days ago. The 35-year-old De Silva stepped down from his position, stating that he wants to "pass the mantle to the next generation".

Batter Pathum Nissanka has also been included in the squad, pending a return to full fitness before the first Test. Nissanka has been laid low by a hamstring injury that he picked up during an ODI series against England last month.

The team will travel to Pakistan for two Tests starting November 9, with matches scheduled in Rawalpindi and Lahore as part of the ongoing World Test Championship cycle.

BHUVNESHWAR'S RECALL IS REWARD FOR HIS SUCCESS, SAYS ASHWIN



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Ravichandran Ashwin believes Bhuvneshwar Kumar never had an India comeback on his mind while consistently delivering for Royal Challengers Bengaluru in the IPL, with the pacer's performances eventually earning him a recall to the national T20I squad after four years.

Bhuvneshwar's inclusion in India's squad for the upcoming five-match T20I series against New Zealand, beginning next week, was among the major talking points following the selection announcement.

Former India off-spinner Ashwin felt the experienced pacer concentrated on his responsibilities rather than worrying about the rewards that could follow his performances.



"I have a feeling that Bhuvneshwar Kumar hasn't even thought about a comeback. I think this will be his mantra for success. And when I'm watching him from afar, I have also experienced this myself, he has gone on his own journey," Ashwin said on his YouTube channel.

"He has focused on doing well, bowling well with the new ball and performing for RCB. Whatever he could do, he did it. His recall is the reward for his success. He never chased that reward; he simply did his job and success followed," he added.

Bhuvneshwar's return has also triggered speculation over Mohammed Shami's international future. Ashwin, however, said a comeback remained possible for the senior pacer, provided he was prepared to put in the required effort.

"It depends on the cricketer. If a player has the belief that he can return, then they have to work hard towards it," said the 40-year-old, who has played 106 Tests for India.

Ashwin also opened up about his relationships with Jasprit Bumrah and Virat Kohli, saying his equation with the former was largely built around light-hearted banter, while his bond with Kohli improved after the latter relinquished the captaincy.

"My relationship with Jassi is very good. We always joke and pull each other's legs. There isn't much conversation between us as cricketers, so our relationship is very banter-oriented," he said.

Gill, Shafali named ICC players of the month

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dubai



India captain Shubman Gill was on Tuesday named ICC men's Player of the Month for a record fifth time following his outstanding performance in the ODI series against the West Indies, while opener Shafali Verma claimed the women's honour for her impressive show in the Asia Cup and the Asian Games.

Gill emulated West Indies captain Haley Matthews, who has also been the ICC Player of the Month on five occasions. The 27-year-old was previously honoured for the months of January and September in 2023, and February and July in 2025.

"It feels fantastic to win my fifth ICC Player of the Month award, and I am grateful to the panel for this honour," said India's Test and ODI captain, who struck a fine 110 in the first ODI against the West Indies in Thiruvananthapuram.

Gill then smashed the quickest double-century ever, his 223 off 133 balls helping his team chase down a huge 406-run target with eight wickets in hand and 39 balls still left.

"It was immensely satisfying to score those runs and even more special to be part of successful run chases in front of our home fans, whose support always gives us an extra boost," Gill said.

"The pace of ODI cricket has gone up significantly, and you must think on your feet, assess the conditions quickly and adapt to the demands of the pitch and the target. Verma, who had won the award in November last year following her match-winning knock in the World Cup final against South Africa in Navi Mumbai, was once again in the spotlight for her performances in big matches.

The aggressive opener was the highest run-scorer for her team as India won the Women's Asia Cup.

Smriti stays atop ODI rankings, Australian players make gains

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dubai



Newly-appointed India captain Smriti Mandhana retained the top spot in the ICC women's ODI batting rankings, while Australia's Ellyse Perry returned to the top 10 in the latest charts released on Tuesday.

Mandhana, who took over the captaincy from Harmanpreet Kaur recently, leads the ODI batting rankings with 790 points. Harmanpreet is the only other Indian batter in the top 10, placed ninth.

In the ODI bowling rankings, Deepti Sharma slipped one place to ninth, while Australia's Annabel Sutherland and Megan Schutt improved their positions to move into the top five. India also had three batters in the top 10 of the women's T20I rankings: Shafali Verma (4th with 759 points), Mandhana (5th with 754 points) and Harmanpreet (10th with 656 points).

SA great Shaun Pollock favours pink ball option in day-time Tests

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Durban





After weather played truant in the ongoing first Test between South Africa and Australia here, former Proteas all-rounder Shaun Pollock has urged the teams to use pink balls in the traditional format to minimise the loss of playing time due to bad light. South Africa were 102 for 4 while chasing 421 at the end of Day 4. But only 221 of the allotted 270 overs could be bowled across the first three days at Kingsmead.

The ICC has recently permitted the usage of pink balls in daytime Tests on a trial basis, subject to both captains agreeing to the arrangement before the match.

Once approved, the pink ball must be used for the entire Test, with no provision to switch back to the red ball. "I am not saying for one moment that we should have used the pink ball and played a day-night game," Pollock told Fox Sports.

"I just believed we should have used the pink ball for the day game. It is not irrelevant because if you use the red ball, all of a sudden you cannot play Test cricket past bad light time, but if you use the pink one, you can," he said.

Pollock was also interested to see which ball — red or pink — the teams would be interested to bowl with when the stakes are high. "If this was a final or a game where you had to win to enter the World Test Championship final and it was 1-all in the series, and Australia was playing South Africa and you tell them, 'Let's use the pink ball because we are going to lose 100 overs to bad light' do you think they would agree or not agree?"

Goalkeeper Krishan Bahadur Pathak returns, India retain Asiad gold-winning core for ACT

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi



Goalkeeper Krishan Bahadur Pathak returned to the Harmanpreet Singh-led Indian men's hockey squad but the core of the Asian Games gold-winning line-up was retained for the Asian Champions Trophy to be held in Punjab from October 27 to November 5.

Harmanpreet had led India to a gold medal at the Asian Games in Japan, where the team successfully defended its continental crown for the first time and qualified for the Los Angeles Olympics. Pathak, who missed the Asian Games, made a comeback, while young defender Amandeep Lakra and midfielder Aditya Arjun Lalage have also earned an opportunity to strengthen their place in the senior setup.

Mid-fielder Vishnu Kant Singh and forward Angad Bir Singh have been named as the two reserve players for the 18-member playing squad. "Playing the ACT in Punjab will be something special," said Chief Coach Craig Fulton.

"This squad blends youth with experience, and we can't wait to feed off the home crowd. There's nothing like playing a tournament in India, and we've missed it."

The tournament holds special significance as it marks the return of international hockey to Punjab.

With matches scheduled in Jalandhar and Mohali, the competition will bring some of Asia's finest hockey talent to a region with a deep-rooted connection to the game.